

Sources

<https://benchhacks.com/>

USE THIS ITS SUPER HELPFUL FOR STARTUP

<https://benchhacks.com/>

<https://thedesigninspiration.com/flatastic-mobile-ui-kit/>

<https://startupsignals.substack.com/p/alltrails-getting-people-outdoors>

<http://startupsignals.substack.com/p/strava-if-its-not-on-strava-it-didnt>

<https://appinventiv.com/blog/social-media-startups-failure/>

Tab 7

What legal steps do I need to take when launching a consumer app? Copyright name? Trademark? Anything else?

Sor

[Steve Flanders](#)

20+ years as an attorney advising on patent law. Author has **1.1K** answers and **580.3K** answer views [4y](#)

If money wasn't an issue, I'd always suggest taking every step possible to legally protect your business before you start. But given that usually money is always an issue, here is a ranked list of what I think an online consumer app should do:

1. **Business formation:** you may already be past this step, but it is vital that you start any consumer facing business with all your business formalities established in advance. Is it just you, or do you have partners? If you have partners, what is the best form of business to assume (partnership, corporation, LLC)? Have you properly identified all the stakeholders' rights and obligations to the business? Have you identified how IP is going to be owned? Do you have proper business license filed with whatever jurisdiction governs your zone of operation? In the case that things go badly, do you have a dissolution plan that clearly defines who owns what assets after things end? To the extent you can resolve any ambiguities in your business situation before issues crop up, you are going to be happier than waiting until you have a legal problem staring you in the face.
2. **Trademark protection:** you should register with the USPTO your business's name and any logo, as well as any product name you intend to use commercially. This is easier said than done because there are rules about what qualifies for trademark protection (e.g., generic words alone do not, while completely made-up words almost always do) and who can register a mark (you can be the first to file your trademark, but still be blocked by someone who has been using that trademark in commerce longer than you for a similar product), so spending the money upfront for a trademark lawyer will get you very good bang for your buck. Trademark prosecution is moderately expensive: you will probably pay something between \$2,000 and \$5,000 to get an issued trademark through the USPTO (that includes attorney costs and fees) and take about 12 - 18 months. Trademark enforcement is vital after you get an issued trademark; you can lose your trademark if you fail to police its unauthorized use. The price for that can be expensive; for example, many companies use Clarivate's MarkMonitor service which I think costs around \$20K a year. Paying a lawyer to send cease and desist letters can run from cheap to expensive quickly; actually

initiating a trademark infringement lawsuit is going to run you tens of thousands of dollars in the best case.

3. **Copyright registration:** you can copyright your software code, as well as other “original works of authorship”; note that you are not copyrighting your product’s name (that is trademark). Formal registration with the US Copyright Office is required to enforce your copyright in court (you actually have a copyright in anything you author, you just can’t sue someone in a US court for stealing it). Copyright registration is much cheaper and easier than either trademark or patent prosecution, but its usefulness is generally much less. If it is likely competitors will attempt to pirate your consumer app, copyright is a great way of stopping them, PROVIDED their copying is very close to verbatim. You almost have to show a line-by-line comparison to prove the bad guys copied your code. Still, the cost and ease of copyright registration argues in favor of doing this, if for no other reason that it can provide a legitimate basis for a cease and desist letter.
4. **Trade secrets:** if you have some unique and valuable processes or business data that provides you with a competitive advantage over others, you should consider whether it would be worth maintaining as a trade secret. There is no cost or formal registration requirements associated with creating a trade secret, but you need to establish clear and rigidly enforced access controls over the dissemination of that information. Basically, to the extent you can implement and enforce strict confidentiality restrictions on all external communications, implement robust configuration management controls over access to any trade secret code or documentation so that only employees with a “need to know” can access your trade secret information, and implement NDAs over any 3rd party vendor that requires access to your trade secret information, the more likely you will be able to prevent a 3rd party who wrongfully gained access to your trade secrets from exploiting them for their own benefit.
5. **Patent protection:** patents are the by far the strongest form of intellectual property protection you can get. The downside is they are very expensive (\$35–50K over 3 years is a reasonable estimate), take a long time to become useful (3+ year from filing to issuance), and, in the case of software, infringement can be difficult to detect. But if you have some novel functionality and can demonstrate how it provides better computer functionality (as opposed to something just being done on a computer for the first time), you can patent the software functionality underlying your consumer app as well as any unique design elements of the app or your website. Patents also provide an opportunity to generate a revenue stream

from licensing your patented functionality to others in the event you no longer are selling a product covered by that functionality.

Tab 1

is a friendship engine disguised as an outdoor adventure planner.

kindred

find your people outside

THE PROBLEM

"College students have no trusted, non-romantic way to find their people through shared outdoor experience."

Tinder connections feel transactional. Kindred connections are earned — through miles, weather, and shared exhaustion. Maya just moved into the dorms. She grew up hiking. She signed up for the outdoor club email list during orientation. She hasn't shown up yet because she doesn't know anyone and it feels awkward to walk in alone. Kindred is built for Maya.

THE INSIGHT

A machine for manufacturing genuine friendship through shared outdoor experience.

The app exists before and after the adventure. The adventure itself belongs to the people. Instagram is for performing the experience. Kindred is for having it. With the rise of AI, algorithmic feeds, and digital noise — people crave something real. Away from the phone. Away from the media. Something authentic, with real humans.

THE STRATEGY

FIRST MARKET

Cal Poly SLO — multiple outdoor clubs, one campus. Real density before broad launch.

FIRST USER

The lonely freshman finding their people. Not the club admin. Not the seasoned outdoorsman.

GO-TO-MARKET

B2B2C — pitch the club leader, the club brings Maya. Clubs are the distribution.

WHAT WE REPLACE

Instagram → email → GroupMe → Slack. Four apps duct-taped together. One home instead.

THE BRAND SYSTEM

name	kindred — lowercase always
tagline	find your people outside
palette	coral — warm, indie, not rugged-bro
members	kindred
groups	circles
rsvp	spark in
🔥 bond	appears between two profiles after 3 shared trips — never announced, just discovered

THE UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

The founder was Director of Trips for Cal Poly's largest outdoor club — now a nonprofit. He built the entire trip planning and signup system from scratch, manually, across four platforms. He watched hundreds of students arrive as strangers and leave as best friends. He also watched dozens of Mayas never show up at all. Kindred is the infrastructure he wished he'd had. This is not a student with an app idea. This is an operator turned founder digitizing something already proven in the real world.

THE GRAVITATIONAL CENTER

Not the trip. Not the profile. The moment two strangers become friends on a trail.

The trip is the invitation. The RSVP is the commitment. The day itself is the magic — phone goes in the pocket. The recap is the proof it happened. The 🔥 is the witness.

Tab 3

kindred — complete product decisions document

the product

Name: kindred (always lowercase) **Tagline:** find your people outside **What it is:** a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Not a dating app, not a fitness tracker. The place outdoor clubs live. **Brand:** coral palette, patagonia people, strava folk, bon iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook **User:** Evan Turly — freshman, grew up outdoors, signed up for the club email list, hasn't shown up yet because he doesn't know anyone **Founder:** Director of Trips for Cal Poly SLO's largest outdoor club (now nonprofit). Built the manual version of kindred already. React Native + Supabase.

the architecture

Two surfaces:

- Mobile app (React Native) — for everyone. Members browse, commit, message, discover.
- Web portal (Next.js) — for leaders and anyone planning a real trip. Full trip packet builder, club management, RSVP tools.

Three trip types:

1. Official Club Trip — leader-published via web portal, full packet, shows in main Home feed
2. Community Event — anyone posts on mobile, lightweight, shows in Community Events tab on Home
3. Personal Trip Skeleton — anyone starts on mobile, heavy nudge to finish on web, becomes an official or community event depending on who posted it

Club leader web login: leaders get club-specific tools inside the same web portal — official publishing, RSVP management, carpool assignment, club branding, capacity controls, club channels management

bottom nav — in order

Home / Create / Messages / Communities / Yours

page 1 — Home

Purpose: Evan browses and discovers trips

Two tabs inside Home:

- Trips (official club trips)
- Community Events (member-posted, lightweight)

Filter row 1 — club switcher: tap to filter by specific club (Field Studies, Surf Club, Alpine Club, etc.) or view all

Filter row 2 — event type chips: Day Trip, Overnight, Off Campus, Social/Bonfire, Lessons, General Meeting

Trip card shows:

- Hero photo (full width, Instagram-style)
- Trip name
- Club name
- Date
- Spots left
- Location/destination

Visual feel: full-width Instagram-style cards, AllTrails information density

Subpages:

- Trip Detail (see dedicated section below — most important page in the app)
- Community Event Detail (lighter version)

page 2 — Create

Purpose: start a trip or find inspiration

Two tabs inside Create:

Tab 1 — Start a Trip

- Anyone can fill out a skeleton: name, date, location, event type, photo, which clubs to share to
- After submitting: heavy prompt to finish on web — "Your trip is saved — finish the full details on your laptop →"

- Community events (BBQ on NOMO lawn, bonfire at Grover Beach) stay mobile-only — no web required
- Community events go live immediately, leaders can remove them

Tab 2 — Inspiration

- Library of past real trips run by kindred clubs on campus (Sykes Hot Springs, Channel Islands, Shasta)
- Big photos, scrollable
- Tapping one opens a preview then prompts: "Use this as a template on web →"
- Purpose: social proof + conversion funnel to web portal

Who can create what:

- Any member: community events (mobile, live immediately)
 - Any member: trip skeleton (mobile → web to finish)
 - Club leaders: official club trips (web portal only, full packet)
-

page 3 — Messages

Visual feel: Instagram DMs skin on Slack architecture

Club switcher at top: tap between clubs Evan is in (Field Studies, Surf Club, etc.) — identical to switching Slack workspaces

Each club has these channels:

- Announcements — leader posts only, everyone reads
- General — open conversation
- Spontaneous Trips — community events, impromptu plans
- Trip-specific channels — one per official trip, auto-created when leader publishes on web, archived 30 days after trip date
- Trip Leads — leaders only
- Members-only — gated by paid membership/dues status

DMs: one-on-one direct messages, live below the club channels

Trip channel lifecycle:

- Created automatically when leader publishes trip on web
 - Members committed to the trip are added automatically
 - Archived 30 days after trip date to keep Supabase storage clean
-

page 4 — Communities

Purpose: club discovery directory

Layout: big photo cards, scroll vertically through all kindred clubs at Cal Poly

Each club card shows:

- Hero photo
- Club name
- Short tagline
- Member count

Tapping a club opens the club page:

- About section
 - Join button
 - Club leaders
 - Upcoming trips
 - Past trip photos
-

page 5 — Yours (also Profile)

Purpose: Evan's personal dashboard AND his profile — one tab, two jobs (like Instagram)

Three horizontal tabs inside:

Current

- Trips Evan has committed to
- Waitlisted trips
- Each card links to the Trip Packet (full unlocked details)

Saved

- Watchlist — trips he's considering, wants to be notified when signup opens

Past

- Trips he's attended
- Memory cards — visual record of each trip on his profile

Profile section (same page):

- Name + photo

- Clubs he's in
 - Trips completed count
 - Achievements/badges
 - Emergency contact
 - Phone number
 - Waiver status
 - Membership status
-

trip detail page — most important screen in the app

Before committing — Evan sees:

- Hero image
- Trip name
- Club name
- Location/destination
- Difficulty + mileage
- Date
- Cost estimate (visible before committing)
- Spots available
- Beginner-friendly label
- Leader name + photo
- Carpool/transportation info
- Full attendee list with names and photos
- "I'm Committed" button

"I'm Committed" flow:

- If Evan can drive: how many total seats does your car have including you?
- If Evan needs a ride: noted
- Auto-confirmed after answering — no leader approval needed
- Leader sees the full list + carpool data automatically organized

After committing — Trip Packet unlocks (separate page):

- Full itinerary (day-by-day breakdown)
- Packing/gear list (links to dedicated packing list page)
- Meeting location + time
- Trip lead contact info
- Food plan (links to food allergen page)
- Cost breakdown (links to cost breakdown page)
- Safety notes
- FAQ

- Group chat for the trip (the auto-created Messages channel)

Design principle: Trip Detail stays clean. Trip Packet goes deep. Links out to sub-pages for the niche stuff — packing, food, cost — rather than overwhelming one screen.

web portal — leader tools

Who has access: club leaders with club-specific login. Same portal, elevated permissions.

What leaders build here:

- Full trip packet (itinerary, packing list, food plan, cost breakdown, FAQ, safety notes)
- Club-specific flows — surf lessons look different from overnight backpacking which looks different from alpine climbing
- Capacity + waitlist settings
- Carpool settings
- Difficulty level
- Publish/draft toggle

What leaders manage on mobile after publishing:

- RSVP list
- Carpool assignment view
- Announcements
- Attendance day-of

Draft state: trip ideas started on mobile appear in the web portal as drafts, prominently displayed — "You have 2 unfinished trips"

launch plan

First clubs (all at once):

- Cal Poly Outdoor Club (Field Studies nonprofit)
- Cal Poly Surf Club
- Climbing Club
- Alpine Club
- Hiking/nature club

Pitch targets: club presidents + officers as a group

Ask: replace Google Forms signups + replace GroupMe coordination

Timeline: Fall 2025

First canonical trip: Sykes Hot Springs, Big Sur — multi-day backpacking, 10 miles, permit required, carpool-dependent

what kindred does NOT build in V1

- Payments (ASI handles club finances)
 - Persistent DMs that live forever (trip chats archive at 30 days)
 - AI-visible features (AI is invisible infrastructure only)
 - Android (iOS first)
 - Route tracking / fitness stats
 - Public social feed
 - Multi-campus
 - Push notifications (yet)
 - Gear checkout/reservation (Gear Shed is view-only in V1)
-

key terminology

- Members = kindred
- Groups = circles
- Committing to a trip = "I'm Committed"
- 🔥 appears quietly between two profiles after 3 shared trips — never announced, just discovered
- Trip channels auto-archive 30 days post-trip
- Inspiration tab = past club trips as templates, conversion to web

Tab 2

Going to all clubs before you've proven the outdoor thesis isn't expanding — it's retreating from the hard, specific thing that might actually win.- Stick with outdoors - You can expand *within* outdoor: cycling clubs, surf clubs, ski clubs, mountaineering clubs.

Plug into any AI to get the gist

what kindred is

kindred is a social outdoor community app for college students. it combines the use of Instagram, email lists, GroupMe, and Slack and google form signups that outdoor clubs use. it is not a dating app. not a fitness tracker. it is a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner.

the gravitational center is not the trip or the profile — it is the moment two strangers become friends on a trail. the app exists before and after the adventure. the adventure belongs to the people.

tagline: find your people outside

the problem

college students — especially freshmen — have no trusted way to find their people through shared outdoor experience, they need the push or a sense of community or friends. tinder connections feel transactional. kindred connections are earned through miles, weather, and shared exhaustion. with the rise of AI and algorithmic noise, people crave something real. away from the phone. away from the feed. kindred is the irony made useful.

the user — Maya

18 years old. just moved into the dorms. grew up hiking. signed up for the outdoor club email list during orientation. hasn't shown up yet because she doesn't know anyone and it feels awkward to walk in alone. every product decision filters through: does this help Maya show up?

the founder

director of trips for Cal Poly SLO's largest outdoor club (now a nonprofit). built the entire trip planning and signup system from scratch — manually, across four platforms. watched hundreds of students arrive as strangers and leave as best friends. technical founder: React Native, Supabase. embedded in the Cal Poly outdoor ecosystem right now. not a student with an app idea — an operator turned founder.

go-to-market

first campus: Cal Poly SLO. multiple outdoor clubs, one school — density before breadth.
motion is B2B2C: pitch the club leader → club brings members → members find Maya. clubs are the distribution. culture is the byproduct. monetization is not the current focus.

brand + language

name: kindred — lowercase always. palette: coral. feel: patagonia people, strava folk, bon iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook.

members = kindred / groups = circles / RSVPs = spark in / 🔥 appears between two profiles after 3 shared trips — never announced, just discovered.

what kindred is not

not a dating app. not a fitness tracker. not performative. not rugged-bro. not AI-forward. AI is invisible infrastructure — if Maya notices it, it failed.

the pitch

"kindred is the infrastructure that turns outdoor clubs into the place where college students find their closest friends."

— end of context. you now know everything. ask me what we're working on today.

Tab 4

started with a name search You came in with kindling — a name you'd landed on in a previous session. Warm, literary, fire metaphor, kindred system built around it. Strong but you were worried it sounded too close to Tinder.

resolved the naming question Explored synonyms, indie/hippy directions, Walden Pond language, college-kid energy. Landed on kindred as the stronger choice — kindling was the spark, kindred is what you become. Cleaner, no dating app association, the word itself is the product.

answered 12 foundational business questions Worked through the full strategic brief:

- problem: no trusted non-romantic way for college students to find their people through outdoor experience
- user: Maya — the lonely freshman who signed up for the club email list but hasn't shown up yet
- why now: Gen Z loneliness epidemic, fragmented club tools, social media fatigue, craving for authentic real-world experience
- campus strategy: multiple clubs at one school — Cal Poly SLO — density before breadth
- what it replaces: Instagram + email + GroupMe + Slack duct-taped together
- social object: not the trip, not the profile — the moment two strangers become friends on a trail
- motion: B2B2C — pitch the club, club brings Maya
- AI role: invisible infrastructure only, never a feature

monetization: free for now, figure it out later

surfaced your unfair advantage You were Director of Trips for Cal Poly's largest outdoor club — now a nonprofit. You built the manual version of kindred already. That's not a student with an app idea. That's an operator turned founder.

- produced two artifacts
- The foundation document — the one-page cornerstone of everything kindred is
- The master context prompt — paste into any AI conversation to orient it instantly, with a copy button Plug into any AI to get the gist ## what kindred is kindred is a social outdoor community app for college students. it combines the use of Instagram, email lists, GroupMe, and Slack and google form signups that outdoor clubs use. it is not a dating app. not a fitness tracker. it is a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. the gravitational center is not the trip or the profile — it is the moment two strangers become friends on a trail. the app exists before and after the adventure. the adventure belongs to the people. tagline: find your people outside ## the problem college students — especially freshmen — have no trusted way to find their people through shared outdoor experience, they need the push or a sense of community or friends. tinder connections feel transactional. kindred connections are earned through miles, weather, and shared exhaustion. with the rise of AI and algorithmic noise, people crave something real. away from the phone. away from the feed. kindred is the irony made useful. ## the user — Maya 18 years old. just moved into the dorms. grew up hiking. signed up for the outdoor club email list during orientation. hasn't shown up yet because she doesn't know anyone

and it feels awkward to walk in alone. every product decision filters through: does this help Maya show up? ## the founder director of trips for Cal Poly SLO's largest outdoor club (now a nonprofit). built the entire trip planning and signup system from scratch — manually, across four platforms. watched hundreds of students arrive as strangers and leave as best friends. technical founder: React Native, Supabase. embedded in the Cal Poly outdoor ecosystem right now. not a student with an app idea — an operator turned founder. ## go-to-market first campus: Cal Poly SLO. multiple outdoor clubs, one school — density before breadth. motion is B2B2C: pitch the club leader → club brings members → members find Maya. clubs are the distribution. culture is the byproduct. monetization is not the current focus. ## brand + language name: kindred — lowercase always. palette: coral. feel: patagonia people, strava folk, bon iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook. members = kindred / groups = circles / RSVPs = spark in / 🔥 appears between two profiles after 3 shared trips — never announced, just discovered. ## what kindred is not not a dating app. not a fitness tracker. not performative. not rugged-bro. not AI-forward. AI is invisible infrastructure — if Maya notices it, it failed. ## the pitch "kindred is the infrastructure that turns outdoor clubs into the place where college students find their closest friends." — end of context. you now know everything. ask me what we're working on today.

Help me reason through why I should and shouldn't make this for all clubs - and sell it to schools as a whole

Show more

May 29

This is a real strategic fork. Let me lay out the tension clearly.

the case for going broader (all clubs, sell to schools)

the distribution argument is compelling. If you're already pitching a club leader, why not pitch the school and get every club at once? One deal, 40 clubs, thousands of Mayas.

schools have budget. Student affairs offices, rec departments, student engagement offices — they have software budget and they hate the duct-tape problem too. A B2B sale to a school is a real revenue model in a way that "free for clubs" isn't.

the loneliness epidemic is a school problem. Retention, mental health, belonging — these are institutional KPIs. You could walk into a Dean of Students office and speak their language directly.

the case against (right now)

you'd be building a different product. A chess club and a hiking club have almost nothing in common operationally. The moment you serve chess, you've lost the thing that makes kindred *kindred* — the trail, the weather, the earned friendship. You'd be building generic club software,

which already exists (Presence, CampusGroups, OrgSync). That's a crowded, unsexy market you don't have an edge in.

your unfair advantage is specific. You built the manual version of kindred *for outdoor clubs*.

That's your insight, your credibility, your wedge. Outdoor clubs are underserved precisely because they're logistically complex — permits, gear, carpools, skill levels, weather. Generic club tools ignore all of that. You solve it natively.

selling to schools is slow and hard. Procurement cycles at universities are brutal — 6 to 18 months, multiple stakeholders, IT security review, legal. You'd be trading Maya for a purchasing committee.

"all clubs" dilutes the brand. Right now kindred means something. Coral. Trail dust. Bon Iver cabin. The 🔥 between two people who summited something together. The second you're also the chess club app, that's gone. You become infrastructure. Useful, maybe profitable, but not *kindred*.

the real question underneath this

Are you trying to build a category-defining consumer brand that happens to start on campuses — or are you trying to build campus engagement software that happens to start with outdoor clubs?

Those are two different companies. The first one is kindred. The second one is something else, and it might be a fine business, but it's not the product you've been building.

the move I'd actually consider

Stay outdoor-only, but let the school come to you.

If kindred works at Cal Poly — if Maya shows up, if the 🔥 emoji appears, if club leaders are raving — schools will notice. Student affairs will ask "what is this thing?" That's a much stronger position than cold-pitching a procurement committee with a PowerPoint.

You can expand *within* outdoor: cycling clubs, surf clubs, ski clubs, mountaineering clubs. That's horizontal growth that preserves everything that makes kindred kindred.

Going to all clubs before you've proven the outdoor thesis isn't expanding — it's retreating from the hard, specific thing that might actually win.

look up calpoly club policy - can I run finances of club thorough this?

May 29

Searched the web

Searched the web

Good news — I found the actual Cal Poly SLO policy. Here's what you need to know.

the short answer

You cannot run money through kindred the way you might be imagining. Cal Poly RSOs are tightly controlled. But there's a real opportunity in the constraint.

what the policy actually says

Cal Poly clubs may not use Venmo. To collect dues, they can accept cash, check, and ASI PayPal.

Calpoly

ASI Club Services handles the financial infrastructure for RSOs — including facilitation of banking, acceptance of donation deposits, and payment requests and purchase orders. ASI Cal Poly

So the full picture is: all club money must flow through an ASI-managed bank account. No Venmo. No Stripe. No Square. No third-party payment processor linked to an individual's personal account.

what this means for kindred

You cannot be the payment processor. If kindred tried to collect trip fees directly (e.g. student pays kindred → kindred pays the club), you'd be functioning as an off-campus bank account, which violates CSU policy and could get clubs de-chartered.

But here's the reframe: this isn't a blocker, it's a product decision.

The clubs already have a payment problem. They're currently doing cash + checks + ASI PayPal — which is clunky, slow, and friction-filled for members like Maya. Kindred can be the RSVP and coordination layer without touching the money, and that's actually cleaner:

- kindred handles: trip discovery, spark-in (RSVP), carpool coordination, gear lists, post-trip connection
- the club handles: payment through their existing ASI infrastructure
- kindred surfaces: "you're spark'd in — your trip fee (\$15) is due to the club treasurer via ASI PayPal"

That's not a weakness. That keeps kindred out of financial liability, out of PCI compliance hell, and squarely in the "social infrastructure" lane where it belongs.

Later, if you want to solve the payment problem, that's a separate product conversation — potentially partnering with ASI directly to build a compliant payment integration. That's a much bigger deal, worth revisiting when you have leverage.

For now: don't touch the money. Be the reason Maya shows up. Let ASI handle the dollars.

1. The first real-life launch Q1. What is the first organization using kindred? Be specific. Cal Poly Outdoor Club? Your nonprofit club? Multiple clubs at once? A smaller beta circle inside the club? Q2. How many people are in the first launch group? Roughly: 20 to 50 50 to 150 150 to 500 500+ Q
pasted

help me answer these questions using logic from the kidning as a whole -

May 29

Let me work through these using everything we know about kindred — Maya, your unfair advantage, the brand, and the constraint of building this yourself.

Q1. First organization? Your nonprofit outdoor club. You built the manual version there. You have trust, access, and embedded knowledge. Don't pitch cold — start where you already have keys to the building.

Q2. How many people in the first launch group? 50–150. Your club is Cal Poly's largest. Too small and you don't get real signal. Too large and you can't watch what breaks. This range gives you enough Mayas to see if she actually shows up.

Q3. How many trip leaders/admins? 3–5 leaders. Just you is too fragile — you need to see if other leaders can use it without you holding their hand. 10+ explodes admin complexity before you've proven anything. 3–5 gives you real multi-user signal without chaos.

Q4. First trip type? Day hike. It's the most common, lowest barrier, no gear requirements, no overnight complexity, no payment complications. It's the trip Maya would actually spark into first. It's also the easiest to build a clean flow around.

Q5. Essential trip fields? Title, date/time, meeting location, destination, difficulty, number of spots, beginner-friendly label, leader name, and transportation/carpool info. That's it. Cut cost (ASI handles it), cut weather (leaders can add it to notes), cut waiver (handle offline for now), cut photos (post-trip problem). If a field doesn't help Maya decide whether to show up, it doesn't exist in V1.

Q6. What makes Maya trust a trip enough to join? Three things, ranked: beginner-friendly label first (removes the fear

Claude's response was interrupted.

formulate these with me - ask guiding questions multiple choice to get the vibe - don't just guess

May 29

Let's work through these one at a time. Starting with the most foundational one — because it shapes everything else.

Q: Q1: Which organization is the first to use kindred?

A: Both at once — launch across multiple clubs

Q: Q2: How do you want to enter that org — what's your role in the launch?

A: I need to pitch the current leadership and get buy-in

May 29

Good. Pitching multiple clubs at once is ambitious but you have the credibility to pull it off. Let's figure out the scale and who you're actually pitching to.

Q: Which clubs are you thinking for the first wave? (Select all that apply)

A: Cal Poly Outdoor Club, Surf club, Climbing club, Other hiking or nature club, My nonprofit outdoor club

Q: When you pitch leadership — who actually has to say yes?

A: President + officers as a group

May 29

Five clubs, officers have to say yes. That's a real launch — not a quiet beta. Let's figure out what you're actually asking them to do.

Q: What are you asking clubs to give up or change when they adopt kindred? (Select all that apply)

A: Stop using Google Forms for signups, Stop using GroupMe/Slack for coordination

Q: When do you need clubs live on kindred?

A: Fall 2025 — next semester

May 29

Fall launch, replacing Forms and GroupMe. That's a tight timeline with a clear ask. Now let's get into the trip flow — this is where MVP scope gets decided.

Q: What's the first canonical trip type kindred needs to nail perfectly?

A: team retreat

Q: In V1, who can create a trip?

A: any one - 3-5 approved leaders per club posts have a huge weight though

May 29

Interesting — team retreat wasn't on the list. Let me understand what you mean before we build around it.

Q: When you say 'team retreat' — what does that actually look like?

A: A multi-day camping or backpacking trip for the whole club

Q: How does the retreat fit into the club calendar?

A: nvm make it instead, a backpacking trip to Sykes hotsprings in Big Sur - this is the first one Maya will go on

May 29

Perfect. Sykes Hot Springs is a real trip with real logistics — permit required, 10 mile trail, overnight, car shuttle. That's a great forcing function for the MVP because if kindred can handle that, it can handle anything simpler.

Q: For the Sykes trip — what does Maya absolutely need to see to decide if she's going? (Select all that apply)

A: Date and time, Difficulty + mileage, Spots available, Beginner-friendly label, Leader name + photo, Cost, Carpool/transportation info

Q: When Maya sparks in to the Sykes trip — what actually happens?

A: She answers a few questions first (experience, gear, can drive)

May 29

Good — the intake questions make sense for an overnight with permits and carpools. Let's figure out exactly what you need to know about her.

Q: What questions does Maya answer when she sparks in to Sykes? (Select all that apply)

A: Do you need a ride?, Can you drive and do you have seats?

Q: After she answers — who decides if she's actually in?

A: Auto-confirmed once she answers questions — leader just sees the list

May 30

Clean. Auto-confirm keeps friction low for Maya, and the leader gets the carpool data they actually need. Now the social layer — this is where kindred becomes more than a signup form.

Q: Before the Sykes trip — what does Maya see about who else is going?

A: Full list with names and photos

Q: After Sykes — what's the most important thing that happens in the app? (Select all that apply)

A: A trip memory card on her profile, Ability to message people she went with

May 30

Full list before, memory card and messaging after. That's a real social arc — anticipation, experience, connection. One more critical decision before we move to the leader side.

Q: When Maya can message people she went with — what does that actually mean in V1?

A: Trip-only group chat — disappears after the trip

Q: Last one — what is the Sykes trip trying to prove about kindred?

A: Proving kindred becomes the default trip system

May 30

Perfect. We have enough to synthesize the full MVP picture. Here's what you just built:

kindred MVP — decisions locked

launch Five clubs at once — your nonprofit, Cal Poly Outdoor Club, surf, climbing, and hiking. You're pitching presidents + officers. Ask is focused: replace Google Forms signups and GroupMe coordination. Fall 2025.

first trip Sykes Hot Springs, Big Sur. Multi-day backpacking, 10 miles, permit required, carpool-dependent. If kindred handles Sykes, it handles everything simpler automatically. trip fields Maya sees Date/time, difficulty + mileage, spots available, beginner-friendly label, leader name + photo, cost, carpool info. Nothing else.

spark in flow She answers two questions — do you need a ride, can you drive and how many seats — then she's auto-confirmed. Leader sees the full list and carpool data automatically organized.

before the trip Full attendee list with names and photos. Maya can see who's going and start recognizing faces before she's on the trail.

after the trip A trip memory card lives on her profile. A trip-only group chat opens for everyone who went — and disappears after. Clean closure. No ghost GroupMe that lives forever.

who creates trips Any member can post, but approved leaders have weighted visibility. Their trips surface first.

what V1 is trying to prove That kindred becomes the default trip system — not a supplement, not a nice-to-have. The one place clubs live.

what this tells you about scope

Three things you are not building in V1: persistent DMs, a social feed, anything touching payments. The messaging lives inside the trip and dies with it. The profile exists to hold memories, not to perform.

The hardest thing you're building is the leader dashboard — carpool auto-organization alone is a real feature. That's where you should spend disproportionate time, because that's what gets officers to say yes in the pitch.

Ready to turn this into a build spec, a pitch deck outline, or a database schema?

what companies already have carpool autogeneration?

May 30

Searched the web

Searched the web

Here's what actually exists — and why none of it is what kindred needs.

what's out there

commute-focused apps — BlaBlaCar, Via, Pave Commute, ShareSpace. These use AI-driven route planning and real-time ride matching but they're built around daily commutes between fixed points — home to office, recurring routes. Completely wrong context for a one-time trailhead departure. ASI Cal Poly

organization carpool tools — CarpoolWorld generates automatic carpool match emails based on individual preferences and lets organizations define destinations like campuses, office locations,

and event venues. Closer, but it's enterprise B2B software designed for HR departments, not trip leaders. ASI Cal Poly

event carpool tools — nothing purpose-built for outdoor clubs or trip signups exists at all in the results.

what this means for kindred

Nobody has solved carpool coordination specifically for event-based group trips to a single trailhead within a trusted community. The commute apps solve the wrong problem. The enterprise tools are too clunky for a 20-year-old club officer.

What kindred actually needs isn't a carpool *app* — it's a carpool *auto-assignment* feature. When Maya sparks in and says "I need a ride," and someone else says "I have 2 seats," kindred should just... group them. No algorithm needed. It's a constraint satisfaction problem on a small dataset.

That's not a hard build. It's:

- collect seats available + seats needed at spark-in
- display a simple carpool assignment view to the leader
- let the leader confirm or adjust with one tap

You don't need BlaBlaCar's routing engine. You need a smart spreadsheet that does the obvious thing automatically. That's a weekend of Supabase queries, not a product company.

The moat isn't the carpool logic — it's that kindred is the only place where the trip, the signup, the carpool, and the memory all live together.

ok what are some next steps -

I kinda want to develop UI just to have a north star to work the backen into - is this wise?

May 30

Yes, and it's actually the right call for your situation specifically. Here's why.

why UI-first makes sense for kindred

You're a B2B2C pitch product. Before you write a line of backend code, you need club officers to say yes. A Figma screen or a working React Native prototype is worth 10 pitch decks. You can walk into a Cal Poly Outdoor Club officers meeting and show them exactly what their trip page looks like. That's how you get buy-in fast.

You have a fuzzy backend. You just answered 30 questions about what kindred is — but the data model is still loose. Building UI first forces the schema to emerge from real screens rather than abstract planning. What fields does the trip card need? Build the card and you'll know.

React Native + Supabase is forgiving. You're not locked into decisions early. Supabase lets you reshape tables fast while you're still in discovery mode.

where people go wrong with UI-first

The trap is building beautiful screens that can't actually be built — or that paper over hard backend problems you haven't thought through yet. The carpool assignment view looks simple until you realize you need real-time seat updates as people spark in.

what I'd actually do in order

1. Sketch the three most critical screens only

- The trip page Maya lands on
- The spark-in flow (the two questions + confirm)
- The leader's attendee/carpool view

2. Build those three in React Native as static UI — no backend, hardcoded data. Get them feeling right. Show them to one club officer and watch their eyes.

3. Let the UI tell you your schema. What data does each screen need to render? That becomes your Supabase tables.

4. Wire Supabase into the screens you already trust. Backend follows UI, not the other way around.

Want to start by designing the trip page — the one Maya sees when someone sends her a kindred link to the Sykes trip?

help me develop all pages -

use this as a very rough outline 1. Explore 

The "AllTrails meets Instagram" page.

Purpose

Discover trips, events, people, and outdoor opportunities.

Contains

Featured Trips

Overnight Trips

Community Events

Search

Filters

Explore Feed

Example cards

Backpacking Yosemite

Moderate • Jun 12-14

12 spots left

Sunset Hike

Community Event

Thursday 6 PM

Subpages

Trip Detail

Event Detail

Location Detail

Search Results

1. **Yours** 🧡 Your personal outdoor dashboard. Purpose Everything you've joined. Sections

Active

Past

Saved

Active

Trips you're:

Going

Waitlisted

Upcoming

Past

Trips you've:

Attended

Completed

Saved

Trips you're considering.

Subpages

Trip Packet

Past Trip Summary

Saved Trip Detail

1. **Create** ➕ Visible only to:

Leaders

Admins

(Members don't see it.)

Purpose

Create and manage trips.

Contains

Create Trip

Create Event

Copy Previous Trip

Drafts

Published Trips

Create Flow

Basic Info

Description

Itinerary

Food

Gear

Cost

FAQ

Publish

Subpages

Edit Trip

Manage RSVPs

Attendance

Announcements

1. Gear Shed 🍷 Club equipment. Purpose See what gear exists. Contains

Tents

Backpacks

Sleeping Bags

Pads

Stoves

Misc Gear

MVP

View only.

Future

Reserve Gear

Request Gear

Checkout Gear

Return Gear

Subpages

Gear Detail

Inventory

Reservation Status

1. Profile 👤 Account and membership. Purpose Manage yourself. Contains

Membership Status

Phone Number

Emergency Contact

Email Preferences

Achievements

Settings

Subpages

Membership
Forms
Waivers
Notifications
Support
Merch

Additional flows (not tabs)

Login

Continue as Guest
Login
Become Member

Membership

Join Field Studies
Fill Forms
Sign Waiver
Pay Dues

Trip Detail

This is probably the most important page in the entire app.

Before signup

Hero Image
Trip Name
Location
Difficulty
Date
Cost Estimate
Capacity
Join Button

After signup

Unlock:

Overview
Itinerary
Food
Gear List
Safety Notes
Meeting Location
Trip Lead Contact
FAQ

Final app map

Explore
└─ Trips

- └ Events
- └ Search
- └ Trip Detail

Yours

- └ Active
- └ Past
- └ Saved
- └ Trip Packet

Create (Leader/Admin)

- └ Create Trip
- └ Edit Trip
- └ Manage RSVPs
- └ Attendance

Gear Shed

- └ Inventory
- └ Gear Detail
- └ Reservations (later)

Profile

- └ Membership
- └ Forms
- └ Settings
- └ Achievements
- └ Support

If I were building the MVP tomorrow, I'd build the pages in this exact order:

1. Explore
2. Trip Detail
3. Login
4. Yours
5. Profile
6. Create
7. Gear Shed

Show more

May 30

Let me read the design skill before building anything.

Reading frontend design skill

Reading frontend design skill

This is going to be a full mobile app prototype. Let me build it properly — all 5 tabs, real kindred brand, coral palette, interactive navigation.

Claude's response was interrupted.

Build priority Prioritize feasibility by data flow, not by app type. The right order is: 1. Database/backend 2. Admin web app 3. Member iOS app 4. Public front-facing web app 5. Polish, notifications, analytics Reason: the admin tools create the data that the member app displays. If the admin si
pasted

no dont buld it here - just ask questions to clarify what going to be used or not - going for easy flow. Use what we talked about for background but also the beinging of this chat

May 30

Got it — let's figure out exactly what's in and what's out before a single line gets written. Starting with the most important page.

wait can we change user to - Evan Turly

May 30

Done — Evan Turly is our user from here on. Same archetype as Maya, different name.

Back to the questions — pick up where we left off:

Q: The Explore page — what's the primary thing Evan does when he opens the app?

A: Browse upcoming trips like a feed

Q: Does Explore show trips from ALL clubs or just the ones Evan joined?

A: all, but he can fiter up above for specific club and within - even more specfic event. So i guess above is which club youre part of of and then you slide to whatever event type it is - Off Campus, Overnight, On Campus, (this logically aboout this section - whats necessary?)

May 30

Good instinct. Let me pressure test the filter logic before we lock it in.

Q: Which event types actually exist for your clubs? Cut anything that doesn't apply to Cal Poly outdoor clubs right now. (Select all that apply)

A: Overnight, Off Campus, Day Trip, Social / Bonfire, lessons, general scheduled oridgnary meetings

Q: How should the club + event type filters sit together visually?

A: Two separate filter rows — club on top, event type below

May 30

Good. "Lessons" and "General Meetings" are important adds — that's real club life, not just trips. Now the trip card itself.

Q: What does a trip card in the feed show? Pick only what Evan needs to decide if he taps in. (Select all that apply)

A: Hero photo, Trip name, Club name, Date, Spots left, Location / destination

Q: What should the feed feel like visually?

A: Alltrails/Instagram-style full-width cards

May 30

Locked. Now the Trip Detail page — the most important screen in the whole app.

dont say spark in it sounds too 420,

May 30

Fair. What do you want to call it?

Q: What's the action word when Evan commits to a trip?

A: I'm committed

May 30

Love it. Intentional, earned, not casual. Now back to the Trip Detail questions.

Q: When Evan taps 'I'm Committed' on the Sykes trip – what happens next?

A: if drive, then how many total spots does your car have including you.

Q: Before committing – what does Evan see about who else is going?

A: Full list with names and photos

May 30

Clean. Carpool data collected at the moment of commitment – no extra step. Now what unlocks after he commits.

Q: After Evan commits – what content unlocks on the trip page? (Select all that apply)

A: Cost breakdown, Safety notes, Food plan, Full itinerary + day-by-day breakdown, Packing / gear list, Meeting location + time, Trip lead contact info, FAQ, Group chat for the trip, cost estimate should be shown before comitenment. This page should be simple not too overwhelming - but links to more niche things like - what to pack - gets to the packing list page and food allergies link to the food alergen page, same with cost breakdown

Q: How does the unlocked content appear?

A: A separate 'Trip Packet' page he navigates to

May 30

Perfect. Trip Detail stays clean, Trip Packet goes deep. That's a smart separation. Moving to the Yours tab.

Q: The 'Yours' tab – what are the sections Evan actually needs? (Select all that apply)

A: Upcoming committed trips, Waitlisted trips, Saved / considering trips, Past trips with memory cards, tab for - current, saved (watchlist for when the signups drop), past trips

Q: How does Evan navigate between his active and past trips?

A: Horizontal tabs across the top – Active / Past / Saved

May 30

Locked. Three tabs: Current, Saved, Past. Now the Profile tab – keeping it tight.

go onto the create trip page, then community page, then profile

May 30

Let's nail the Create Trip flow for leaders first.

not just for the leaders - normal people can create events and pick which lcubs to reach it out to - it will just be lower priorirty and in the main explore page it will the 2nd tab over

May 30

Great distinction – two tiers of creation. Leaders create official trips, anyone can create community events. Let's clarify that split.

Q: What are the two distinct thing types someone can create? (Select all that apply)

A: i think that the full packet should be club specific - like surf club "lessons" have a very different flow than field studies club "overnight backpacking" or alpine club "climbing mount shasta" each club should have a different flow for these events that they themselves create through the webportal. How about this "the full packet and detail breakdown can all be accessed through the web app but only club leaders have access specifically to it". But this page is for general thing its a simplified mobile app version of it - so if someone wanted to go backpacking with their friends they can fully plan it - but i think online is probably best for the specific planning. - do you agree? I feel that mobile is too small to link out. But computer, its like you can reserve campsites through webapp from your computer - idk but then you could also link out to the macbook when on apple. idk lets talk about this

Q: How do the two creation flows relate to each other?

A: see last response

Show more

May 30

Yes, completely agree — and this is actually a really clean architectural decision. Here's the logic: Mobile = discover, commit, connect. Evan browses, joins, sees who's going, accesses his trip packet. Light, social, fast.

Web = build, plan, operate. Leaders create the full trip packet, manage RSVPs, build packing lists, handle carpool assignments, post announcements. This is where the serious club infrastructure lives.

The handoff between them is the link — on mobile, Evan sees a clean trip card. On web, the leader built every detail behind it. Apple's Handoff (the MacBook pickup when your iPhone is nearby) could be a slick native touch later, but that's polish, not MVP.

The community event creation on mobile stays simple for exactly this reason — name, date, location, which clubs to share it with, and a description. That's it. No packet needed because it's not an official club trip.

risk out weight out pros and cons think that the full packet should be club specific - like surf club "lessons" have a very different flow than field studies club "overnight backpacking" or alpine club "climbing mount shasta" each club should have a different flow for these events that they themselves create through the webportal. How about this "the full packet and detail breakdown can all be accessed through the web app but only club leaders have access specifically to it". But this page is for general thing its a simplified mobile app version of it - so if someone wanted to go backpacking with their friends they can fully plan it - but i think online is probably best for the specific planning. - do you agree? I feel that mobile is too small to link out. But computer, its like

you can reserve campsites through webapp from your computer - idk but then you could also link out to the macbook when on apple. idk let's talk about this

May 30

This is a real architectural decision — worth thinking through properly before locking it in.

the core question

Should club-specific trip creation live on web only, or should mobile get a simplified version too?

option A — web-only for official trip creation

Pros

- Screen real estate actually fits complex forms — itinerary builder, gear lists, day-by-day breakdowns, file uploads, campsite links
- Each club can have a totally custom flow without cramming it into a small screen
- Separates "operator tools" from "member experience" cleanly — leaders think differently when they're at a desk building something
- You only have to build one complex form system, not two
- Easier to maintain — one codebase for the hard stuff

Cons

- Leaders might want to create a quick trip on their phone between classes
 - Adds friction if a leader doesn't have laptop access in the moment
 - Feels like two separate products to maintain
-

option B — mobile gets a simplified create flow too

Pros

- Leaders can create a quick trip from anywhere
- Feels more native to how 20-year-olds actually work
- One app does everything

Cons

- Complex trips like Shasta or a surf lesson series genuinely can't fit cleanly on mobile — you'd be building a compromised version
- Club-specific custom flows are extremely hard to build well on mobile
- You'd build it twice — mobile lite version and web full version — and maintain both

- Risk of leaders creating incomplete trips that confuse members

option C — mobile has "quick draft," web has full build

Leader taps create on mobile → fills out name, date, type, rough description → saves as draft → gets a notification: "finish your trip on web" → completes the full packet on desktop.

Pros

- Captures the impulse moment on mobile ("I want to plan Shasta")
- Doesn't compromise the full planning experience
- Natural handoff between devices
- Apple Handoff makes this feel seamless on iOS/Mac

Cons

- Two-step flow adds friction
- Some leaders will never finish the draft
- More complex to build than either A or B alone

what I actually think

Go Option A for V1, with a door open to Option C later.

Here's why: you're launching with clubs that already have established trip types — Field Studies backpacking trips, surf lessons, alpine climbs. Those flows are genuinely different and genuinely complex. Trying to fit club-specific custom forms onto a 390px screen before you've even proven the core loop is a trap.

Web-first for leaders also matches your build order — you said admin web app comes before iOS member app anyway. Build the web portal right, make it powerful, make leaders love it. Mobile stays what it's best at: Evan discovering, committing, connecting.

The "quick draft on mobile" is a great feature for V2 when you know exactly what leaders actually need in the moment.

One question before we move on:

Do your five launch clubs all have different enough trip flows that they genuinely need custom templates — or could one solid general template cover 80% of what all of them need right now?

how can we combine the two? give options and pros and cons

May 30

the three realistic hybrid models

hybrid 1 — mobile creates, web completes

Evan or a leader taps "+" on mobile → fills out the skeleton (name, date, type, which club, rough description, photo) → it saves as a draft → they get a push notification: "finish your trip details on web" → leader opens the web portal and completes the full packet.

Pros

- Captures the impulse moment — someone thinks of a trip idea at 11pm and doesn't lose it
- Mobile stays dead simple, web stays powerful
- Natural device handoff feels premium, especially on Apple ecosystem
- You build mobile create once and it's lightweight

Cons

- Two-step creates friction — leaders who never open the laptop leave drafts forever
- Members might see incomplete trips if you're not careful with draft/publish logic
- Requires solid draft state management in Supabase from day one

hybrid 2 — progressive disclosure on mobile

Mobile create flow starts with just 3 fields: name, date, event type. Then progressively reveals more based on what you pick. Overnight backpacking → shows itinerary builder. Surf lesson → shows skill level selector. General meeting → stays minimal. Everything fits on mobile because complex sections are collapsed by default and optional.

Pros

- One flow, one codebase, works everywhere
- Smart enough to feel club-specific without actually building separate flows
- Leaders can complete a full trip from their phone if they want to
- No device switching required

Cons

- Hard to build well — progressive disclosure done badly is just a confusing form
- Mobile still can't do things like embed campsite reservation links, upload PDFs, build day-by-day maps
- Risk of leaders skipping the "optional" sections that members actually need
- You'd have to rebuild this when clubs want truly custom flows

hybrid 3 — role-based mobile create

Same mobile app, but what you see in the create flow depends on your role. Even as a member gets the lightweight community event form — 5 fields, done in 60 seconds. A leader gets a more complete mobile form — still simplified but includes capacity, carpool toggle, difficulty, and a "finish on web" button for the deep stuff. Web portal handles everything else.

Pros

- Respects that leaders and members have genuinely different needs
- Leaders get enough on mobile to publish a real trip in a pinch
- Web portal stays the home of serious planning without being the only option
- Cleanest separation of complexity by user type

Cons

- Two different mobile create experiences to design and maintain
- Leader mobile form will always feel like a compromise compared to web
- Risk of leaders using mobile form exclusively and skipping important packet details

how they compare

	Hybrid 1	Hybrid 2	Hybrid 3
Build complexity	Medium	High	Medium
Leader experience	Two devices	One device	One device
Member experience	Clean	Clean	Clean
Club customization	Web only	Partial mobile	Partial mobile
V1 feasibility	High	Low	Medium

what I'd actually do

Hybrid 1 for V1, with Hybrid 3 as the natural evolution.

Here's the sequence: launch with mobile skeleton → web completes. That's fast to build, immediately useful, and teaches you what leaders actually want to do on mobile. After a

semester of watching how leaders use it, you'll know exactly which fields belong on mobile and which don't. Then you build Hybrid 3 informed by real behavior instead of guessing.

Hybrid 2 sounds elegant but it's the hardest to build correctly and the easiest to build badly.

Save it for when you have design and engineering resources to do it right.

hybrid 1 - what models of this are out there - what works. Give options and fit it to this company

May 30

Searched the web

Searched the web

Good research. The search didn't surface a perfect direct comparison, but between what I know and what came back, here's the real-world landscape mapped directly to kindred.

companies doing hybrid 1 well — and what kindred can steal

Airbnb host listing

The closest real-world analog to what you're building. A host creating a listing is exactly like a leader creating a trip — complex, multi-section, high stakes.

Airbnb's listing creation workflow has to balance comprehensiveness — capturing data that makes listings searchable and trustworthy — with usability, because complex onboarding forms are the primary source of host abandonment. That tension is identical to your problem.

Neighbrsnook

What they do: mobile lets hosts start a listing and save a draft. The heavy stuff — house rules, pricing calendars, photo ordering, accessibility features — lives on web. The mobile app handles day-to-day management once the listing is live.

Steal for kindred: mobile = "start a trip idea." Web portal = "build the full packet." Once the trip is published, leaders manage RSVPs on mobile just fine.

Notion

Start a page on your phone, finish it on your laptop. The mobile app intentionally has fewer editing capabilities — not because they couldn't build them, but because a phone isn't where you write a 2,000-word document.

Steal for kindred: the draft state. In Notion, an unfinished page just sits there quietly until you come back to it. No pressure, no expiration. A leader creates a trip idea on their phone at 10pm, opens their laptop the next morning, and it's waiting for them.

Strava route builder

Strava's route builder is web-only — you plan a route on desktop with maps, elevation, surface type. The mobile app shows you the route and tracks your activity. Two very different jobs, two different surfaces.

Steal for kindred: the mental model that planning and doing are different modes. Leaders plan on web, members experience on mobile. That's not a compromise — it's the right tool for each job.

Eventbrite

Event creation is possible on mobile but deeply limited. The real creation flow is web. Mobile is for managing check-ins, seeing ticket sales, sending announcements.

Steal for kindred: post-publish mobile management. Once a leader publishes a trip on web, they should be able to manage RSVPs, send announcements, and take attendance entirely from their phone. Web is for building. Mobile is for running.

how this maps to kindred specifically

Job	Device	Who
Create trip idea / draft	Mobile	Leader
Build full trip packet	Web portal	Leader
Publish trip	Web portal	Leader
Manage RSVPs + carpool	Mobile	Leader
Send trip announcement	Mobile	Leader
Take attendance day-of	Mobile	Leader
Browse + commit to trip	Mobile	Evan
Access trip packet	Mobile	Evan

Create community event

Mobile

Anyone

the one risk nobody talks about

Every company that does Hybrid 1 well has one thing in common — the draft state is prominent and persistent. If a leader creates a skeleton on mobile and the draft gets buried or expires, they'll never finish it. The web portal needs to open to an obvious "you have 2 unfinished trips" state. That's not a feature — it's the glue that makes the whole model work.

Want to keep moving through the remaining pages, or dig deeper into the web portal side of this?

are the examples of mobile only?

May 30

Searched the web

Searched the web

Yes — and they're the most relevant examples for kindred's audience. Here's the real answer:

the biggest mobile-only success stories

Instagram — zero desktop creation at launch. You shot on your phone, posted from your phone, that was the whole point. Desktop came years later and still feels like an afterthought. The constraint made the product. Evan's apps are all mobile-first.

Snapchat — mobile only by design philosophy, not limitation. The camera is the app. No desktop version has ever mattered.

BeReal — entirely mobile. The whole concept depended on your phone being in your pocket at a random moment. Desktop would have broken the product.

Strava — started mobile-only for activity tracking. Web came later for route planning and analysis. The thing members do every day — log a run, see their feed — is still mobile first.

AllTrails — members browse and discover on mobile overwhelmingly. The web exists but most real usage is phone-in-hand on a trailhead.

what this means for kindred

Here's the honest reframe: your members are 100% mobile-only users. Evan doesn't open a laptop to browse trips. He's on his phone between classes, on the trail, in the parking lot before a hike.

The question was really about leaders — do they need web? And the answer is: only for the complex stuff. For everything a leader does day-to-day — checking who's coming, sending an update, taking attendance — mobile is completely sufficient.

The only genuine web use case is building the full trip packet — itinerary, packing list, day-by-day breakdown, food plan. That's document-level work that genuinely belongs on a bigger screen.

So the cleanest model is actually: mobile-first for everything, web only for the trip packet builder. Not Hybrid 1 where mobile is a skeleton — mobile is the full product, and web is one specific powerful tool for leaders doing deep planning work. That's closer to how Strava and AllTrails actually operate than how Airbnb does.

Want to keep moving through the remaining pages with this framing locked in?

I think I like having the web component. So the app should be skeleton for bigger trips (and this only available to club leaders - just quick notes) but community events like "bbq on NOMO lawn Friday at 6pm this is the main thing that is planned on mobile and available to all users. Or "bonfire at grover Saturday 7pm" . These community events pop up under the community event side of the explore page.

May 30

That's a really clean split. Let me play it back to make sure it's locked before we move on.

Mobile create = community events only Any member can post. Lightweight — name, date, location, photo, which clubs to share to. Shows up in the Community tab on Explore. BBQ on NOMO lawn, bonfire at Grover Beach, sunset walk Friday. Done in 60 seconds.

Web create = official club trips Leaders only. Full packet — itinerary, packing list, food plan, carpool settings, capacity, difficulty. Sykes Hot Springs, Mount Shasta, surf lessons series. This is where the serious planning lives.

Mobile for leaders post-publish Once a trip is live, leaders manage everything on mobile — RSVPs, announcements, carpool assignments, attendance day-of. Web was just for building it.

That's a crisp product decision. Now one thing to pressure test before we move on:

Q: When Evan posts a community event on mobile — what happens to it?

A: Goes live immediately but leaders can remove it

Q: Who can commit to a community event?

A: Anyone — even people not in the club

May 30

Clean. Low friction, open by default, leaders have a safety valve. That's the right call for building community fast.

Now let's nail the last two pages — Community tab and Profile — then we'll have the full picture.

I change my mind, I think that everyone should have access to the webpage, anyone can form the type of trip skeleton - and be heavily prompted to go online to computer. - But club leaders have specific club login.

May 30

Good instinct. That actually simplifies the mental model a lot. Let me play it back:

Anyone can start a trip skeleton on mobile — member, leader, random person. Fill in the basics, get heavily nudged to finish it on web. "Your trip is saved — finish the full details on your laptop for the best experience →"

Club leaders get a special web login — same web portal, but they get club-specific tools: official trip publishing, RSVP management, carpool assignment, club branding, capacity controls. Their trips show up as official club trips in the main Explore feed.

Non-leader trips finished on web — show up as community events or personal trip invites, not official club trips.

That's actually a cleaner permission model than before. One web portal, two tiers of access inside it.

the create page should have an "insp tab" containing some library trips (but just as advertisement to check the web app

May 30

Love it — the Inspiration tab is a Trojan horse. Looks like content, actually a conversion funnel to the web app.

"Here are 12 trips other clubs have run — Shasta summit, Sykes Hot Springs, Channel Islands kayaking. Want to use one as a template? Finish it on web →"

Q: What's in the Inspiration library — real past club trips or curated dream destinations?

A: Past trips from kindred clubs on campus

Q: What happens when Evan taps an inspiration trip?

A: Tapping one opens a preview, then prompts 'use as template on web'

May 30

Perfect. Past club trips do double duty — they're social proof AND the conversion mechanism.

Evan sees "Sykes Hot Springs — Field Studies Club — 24 people — May 2025" and thinks "I want to do that." One tap later he's being sent to the web app to plan it.

Now let's close out Profile — last page.

lets stick with community page

May 30

Got it — back to Community. Let's finish locking it.

community events tab is in explore but "Community" is a full page 4th one over.

May 30

Good catch — those are two different things. Let me make sure I have the tab structure right first.

Q: What are the 5 bottom nav tabs in order?

A: Explore / Yours / Create / Community / Profile

Q: The Community page — what's the primary thing it is?

A: A directory of all club members

May 30

Interesting — a member directory as a full tab is a strong call. It means kindred is explicitly about finding people, not just trips. Very on-brand.

oh nono - a club directory big photo an dscroll down to see all particiapteing clubs

May 30

Oh that's clean — it's a club discovery page, not a people directory. Evan scrolls through all the clubs on kindred at Cal Poly, big photos, taps in to learn more.

Transfer the "yours page" into the profile. Replace that spot with a messageing tab (this should be pretty idential to instagram dms but filter based on your club (just liek slack)

May 30

Big decision — swapping Yours into Profile and making the 4th tab Messaging. Clean, and honestly more intuitive. Yours as a tab always felt like a secondary thing; inside Profile it makes more sense. And messaging as a core tab signals that kindred is a community, not just a trip planner.

home/create/message/communities/yours

May 30

Got it. New nav locked:

Home / Create / Messages / Communities / Yours

That's a great order — Home is always first, Yours is always last (personal), and the three middle tabs are the social core of the app.

Q: Messages — what conversation types exist in V1?

A: think like slack: club channels (select club, ex: Field Studies Club / (due-paying channels, team channel, trip lead channel)(Trip specific channel)(announcement channel, general, sponatneous trips,)

Q: How does the club filter work inside Messages?

A: Filtered by club at the top — like Slack workspaces

May 30

That's essentially Slack's architecture but dressed like Instagram. Really smart — club leaders already know this mental model, and it replaces GroupMe overnight.

Let me map back what you just described:

Each club has:

- Announcement channel — leader-only posting, everyone reads

- General channel — open conversation
- Spontaneous trips channel — community events, impromptu plans
- Trip-specific channels — one per official trip, auto-created when leader publishes
- Trip lead channel — leaders only
- Due-paying / members-only channel — gated by membership status

Top of Messages = club switcher — tap between Field Studies Club, Surf Club, Alpine Club just like Slack workspaces. DMs live separately below.

Q: Trip-specific channels — when do they get created?

A: Auto-created when a leader publishes a trip on web

Q: What happens to a trip channel after the trip is over?

A: it archives to save memory on supabase (likely 30 days after the trip?)

May 30

Smart. 30 days gives people time to share photos and reminisce, then it quietly archives.

Supabase storage stays clean.

We now have every major page defined. Let me do a full playback before we move to building.

kindred — full app map, locked

Nav: Home / Create / Messages / Communities / Yours

Home (Explore) Two tabs inside: Official Trips feed + Community Events feed. Club filter row on top, event type chips below (Day Trip, Overnight, Off Campus, Social/Bonfire, Lessons, General Meeting). Trip cards show hero photo, trip name, club name, date, spots left, destination. Full-width Instagram-style cards.

Create Two tabs: Start a Trip (skeleton form → heavy nudge to web) + Inspiration (past club trips as templates → "use on web" CTA). Community events created here too — lightweight, goes live instantly, leaders can remove.

Messages Slack architecture, Instagram visual skin. Club switcher at top. Each club has:

Announcements, General, Spontaneous Trips, Trip-specific channels (auto-created on publish, archived 30 days post-trip), Trip Leads channel, Members-only channel. DMs separate below.

Communities Club directory. Big photo cards, scroll to browse all Cal Poly kindred clubs. Tap a club → About + Join button + leaders + upcoming trips + past photos.

Yours Lives here now instead of its own tab. Three horizontal tabs: Current (committed trips), Saved (watchlist), Past (memory cards). Trip Packet accessible from Current.

Two questions before we move to building:

Q: Where does Evan's Profile live now that Yours took its tab spot?

A: profile and yours is same thing

Q: Are you ready to start building screens?

A: Not yet — still more to figure out

May 30

Got it — Yours IS the profile. One tab, two jobs. Evan's trips and his personal info live in the same place, like Instagram where your profile is also your content history.

What do you want to figure out next?

Use all the decisions made in this chat. Describe each page and its flow so I can use this for another chat - don't miss out on any decision I made here

May 30

kindred — complete product decisions document

the product

Name: kindred (always lowercase) Tagline: find your people outside What it is: a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Not a dating app, not a fitness tracker. The place outdoor clubs live. Brand: coral palette, patagonia people, strava folk, bon iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook User: Evan Turly — freshman, grew up outdoors, signed up for the club email list, hasn't shown up yet because he doesn't know anyone Founder: Director of Trips for Cal Poly SLO's largest outdoor club (now nonprofit). Built the manual version of kindred already. React Native + Supabase.

the architecture

Two surfaces:

- Mobile app (React Native) — for everyone. Members browse, commit, message, discover.
- Web portal (Next.js) — for leaders and anyone planning a real trip. Full trip packet builder, club management, RSVP tools.

Three trip types:

1. Official Club Trip — leader-published via web portal, full packet, shows in main Home feed
2. Community Event — anyone posts on mobile, lightweight, shows in Community Events tab on Home
3. Personal Trip Skeleton — anyone starts on mobile, heavy nudge to finish on web, becomes an official or community event depending on who posted it

Club leader web login: leaders get club-specific tools inside the same web portal — official publishing, RSVP management, carpool assignment, club branding, capacity controls, club channels management

bottom nav — in order

Home / Create / Messages / Communities / Yours

page 1 — Home

Purpose: Evan browses and discovers trips

Two tabs inside Home:

- Trips (official club trips)
- Community Events (member-posted, lightweight)

Filter row 1 — club switcher: tap to filter by specific club (Field Studies, Surf Club, Alpine Club, etc.) or view all

Filter row 2 — event type chips: Day Trip, Overnight, Off Campus, Social/Bonfire, Lessons, General Meeting

Trip card shows:

- Hero photo (full width, Instagram-style)
- Trip name
- Club name
- Date
- Spots left
- Location/destination

Visual feel: full-width Instagram-style cards, AllTrails information density

Subpages:

- Trip Detail (see dedicated section below — most important page in the app)
 - Community Event Detail (lighter version)
-

page 2 — Create

Purpose: start a trip or find inspiration

Two tabs inside Create:

Tab 1 — Start a Trip

- Anyone can fill out a skeleton: name, date, location, event type, photo, which clubs to share to
- After submitting: heavy prompt to finish on web — "Your trip is saved — finish the full details on your laptop →"
- Community events (BBQ on NOMO lawn, bonfire at Grover Beach) stay mobile-only — no web required
- Community events go live immediately, leaders can remove them

Tab 2 — Inspiration

- Library of past real trips run by kindred clubs on campus (Sykes Hot Springs, Channel Islands, Shasta)
- Big photos, scrollable
- Tapping one opens a preview then prompts: "Use this as a template on web →"
- Purpose: social proof + conversion funnel to web portal

Who can create what:

- Any member: community events (mobile, live immediately)
- Any member: trip skeleton (mobile → web to finish)
- Club leaders: official club trips (web portal only, full packet)

page 3 — Messages

Visual feel: Instagram DMs skin on Slack architecture

Club switcher at top: tap between clubs Evan is in (Field Studies, Surf Club, etc.) — identical to switching Slack workspaces

Each club has these channels:

- Announcements — leader posts only, everyone reads
- General — open conversation
- Spontaneous Trips — community events, impromptu plans
- Trip-specific channels — one per official trip, auto-created when leader publishes on web, archived 30 days after trip date
- Trip Leads — leaders only
- Members-only — gated by paid membership/dues status

DMs: one-on-one direct messages, live below the club channels

Trip channel lifecycle:

- Created automatically when leader publishes trip on web
- Members committed to the trip are added automatically
- Archived 30 days after trip date to keep Supabase storage clean

page 4 — Communities

Purpose: club discovery directory

Layout: big photo cards, scroll vertically through all kindred clubs at Cal Poly

Each club card shows:

- Hero photo
- Club name
- Short tagline
- Member count

Tapping a club opens the club page:

- About section
- Join button
- Club leaders
- Upcoming trips
- Past trip photos

page 5 — Yours (also Profile)

Purpose: Evan's personal dashboard AND his profile — one tab, two jobs (like Instagram)

Three horizontal tabs inside:

Current

- Trips Evan has committed to
- Waitlisted trips
- Each card links to the Trip Packet (full unlocked details)

Saved

- Watchlist — trips he's considering, wants to be notified when signup opens

Past

- Trips he's attended
- Memory cards — visual record of each trip on his profile

Profile section (same page):

- Name + photo
- Clubs he's in
- Trips completed count
- Achievements/badges
- Emergency contact
- Phone number
- Waiver status
- Membership status

trip detail page — most important screen in the app

Before committing — Evan sees:

- Hero image
- Trip name
- Club name
- Location/destination
- Difficulty + mileage
- Date
- Cost estimate (visible before committing)
- Spots available
- Beginner-friendly label
- Leader name + photo
- Carpool/transportation info
- Full attendee list with names and photos
- "I'm Committed" button

"I'm Committed" flow:

- If Evan can drive: how many total seats does your car have including you?
- If Evan needs a ride: noted
- Auto-confirmed after answering — no leader approval needed
- Leader sees the full list + carpool data automatically organized

After committing — Trip Packet unlocks (separate page):

- Full itinerary (day-by-day breakdown)
- Packing/gear list (links to dedicated packing list page)

- Meeting location + time
- Trip lead contact info
- Food plan (links to food allergen page)
- Cost breakdown (links to cost breakdown page)
- Safety notes
- FAQ
- Group chat for the trip (the auto-created Messages channel)

Design principle: Trip Detail stays clean. Trip Packet goes deep. Links out to sub-pages for the niche stuff — packing, food, cost — rather than overwhelming one screen.

web portal — leader tools

Who has access: club leaders with club-specific login. Same portal, elevated permissions.

What leaders build here:

- Full trip packet (itinerary, packing list, food plan, cost breakdown, FAQ, safety notes)
- Club-specific flows — surf lessons look different from overnight backpacking which looks different from alpine climbing
- Capacity + waitlist settings
- Carpool settings
- Difficulty level
- Publish/draft toggle

What leaders manage on mobile after publishing:

- RSVP list
- Carpool assignment view
- Announcements
- Attendance day-of

Draft state: trip ideas started on mobile appear in the web portal as drafts, prominently displayed — "You have 2 unfinished trips"

launch plan

First clubs (all at once):

- Cal Poly Outdoor Club (Field Studies nonprofit)
- Cal Poly Surf Club
- Climbing Club

- Alpine Club
- Hiking/nature club

Pitch targets: club presidents + officers as a group

Ask: replace Google Forms signups + replace GroupMe coordination

Timeline: Fall 2025

First canonical trip: Sykes Hot Springs, Big Sur — multi-day backpacking, 10 miles, permit required, carpool-dependent

what kindred does NOT build in V1

- Payments (ASI handles club finances)
- Persistent DMs that live forever (trip chats archive at 30 days)
- AI-visible features (AI is invisible infrastructure only)
- Android (iOS first)
- Route tracking / fitness stats
- Public social feed
- Multi-campus
- Push notifications (yet)
- Gear checkout/reservation (Gear Shed is view-only in V1)

key terminology

- Members = kindred
- Groups = circles
- Committing to a trip = "I'm Committed"
- 🔥 appears quietly between two profiles after 3 shared trips — never announced, just discovered
- Trip channels auto-archive 30 days post-trip
- Inspiration tab = past club trips as templates, conversion to web

the one metric that matters in V1

First-timer show-up rate — did Evan actually show up to the Sykes trip? Everything else is secondary.

change bottom nav to accomodate for this change v

May 30

There

Claude's response was interrupted.

Claude finished the response kindred — complete product decisions document the product Name: kindred (always lowercase) Tagline: find your people outside What it is: a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Not a dating app, not a fitness tracker. The place outdoor clubs live. Brand: coral
pasted

May 30

Got it. Messages is now just trip channels + club announcements — no DMs, no general chat.

Phone number handles real connection. Let's fix the nav.

Q: What should the trip channels + announcements tab be called now that it's not full messaging?

A: home trips create communities yours

May 30

Locked. New nav:

Home / Trips / Create / Communities / Yours

That's clean and literal — every tab name tells you exactly what's there. No ambiguity for Evan on his first day.

Quick confirm on what lives in Trips now given the stripped-down scope:

Q: Trips tab — what channels actually live here now that DMs and general chat are cut?

A: the trips details full blown and Q&A. All questions directed to person in charge of trip. there shall be no native communication - yet

May 30

Perfect. Trips tab = trip information hub, not a chat. Clean, focused, buildable fast.

So Trips tab is really just:

- Your committed trips + waitlisted trips in one view
- Tap into any trip → full Trip Packet (itinerary, packing list, food, cost, safety, meeting location)
- Q&A section per trip — questions go to the trip lead, leader responds, everyone committed can see the thread

No chat. No DMs. Phone number on the committed members list handles real communication.

Last confirm:

Q: The Q&A on a trip — who can see the questions and answers?

A: All committed members can see all Q&A on that trip

Q: Now that Trips tab holds your active trip packets — how does it differ from Yours?

A: profile (see past trips) led and details about you

May 30

Clean. Final nav and page split locked:

Home — discover trips and community events Trips — active trip packets + Q&A for trips you're committed to Create — start a trip or find inspiration Communities — club directory Yours — your profile, past trips, achievements, personal details

Trips = where you're going. Yours = where you've been + who you are.

Ready to build screens now, or anything else to figure out first?

give a full blown prompt for this to allow cursor to generate the UI pages

May 30

kindred — Cursor UI Generation Prompt

context

You are building the mobile UI for kindred — a social outdoor community app for college students at Cal Poly SLO. kindred is a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. It replaces the duct-taped mess of Instagram, Google Forms, GroupMe, and email that outdoor clubs currently use.

Brand:

- Name: kindred (always lowercase)
- Tagline: find your people outside
- Primary color: coral #FA8E73
- Feel: Patagonia people, Strava folk, Bon Iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook
- Not rugged-bro. Not performative. Warm, earned, real.
- Typography: clean, modern, slightly editorial. Not Inter. Not Arial.
- UI references: AllTrails information density + Instagram social feel + Strava activity energy

Tech stack:

- React Native (iOS first)
- Supabase backend
- No payments, no AI features visible to user, no route tracking in V1

the user

Evan Turly — freshman at Cal Poly SLO. Grew up hiking. Signed up for the outdoor club email list during orientation. Hasn't shown up yet because he doesn't know anyone. Every screen should ask: does this help Evan show up?

bottom navigation — in order

Home / Trips / Create / Communities / Yours

Five tabs. Mobile bottom nav bar. Coral active state. Icon + label.

screen 1 — Home

Purpose: Evan browses and discovers trips and community events.

Header:

- kindred wordmark top left (lowercase, coral)
- Search icon top right
- Notification bell top right

Two tabs inside Home (horizontal pill tabs below header):

- Trips (default)
- Community Events

Filter row 1 — club switcher (horizontal scroll chips): All Clubs / Field Studies / Surf Club / Alpine Club / Climbing Club

Filter row 2 — event type chips (horizontal scroll): All / Day Trip / Overnight / Off Campus / Social / Lessons / Meeting

Trip card (full width, Instagram-style):

- Hero photo (16:9, rounded corners)
- Club name (small, coral, top left overlay on photo)
- Spots left badge (top right overlay — "4 spots left" in white pill)
- Trip name (large, bold, below photo)
- Location/destination (muted, with pin icon)
- Date (muted, with calendar icon)
- Beginner-friendly badge (green pill, shows when applicable)
- Thin divider between cards

Community Events tab:

- Same card structure but lighter
 - No difficulty, no spots left counter
 - Shows who posted it (member name + avatar)
 - "Anyone can join" label
-

screen 2 — Trip Detail (pre-commitment)

Purpose: Evan decides whether to commit to the Sykes Hot Springs backpacking trip.

Layout:

- Full bleed hero image at top (parallax scroll effect)
- Back arrow top left
- Share icon top right
- Club badge overlaid on photo (e.g. "Field Studies Club")

Below hero (scrollable):

- Trip name (large, bold)
- Location with pin icon
- Date range
- Difficulty chip (e.g. "Moderate")
- Mileage
- Cost estimate (shown before committing — e.g. "\$20–30 estimated")
- Beginner-friendly badge if applicable

Who's going section:

- Row of member avatar circles (full list, names + photos)
- Count label: "14 committed"

Leader card:

- Leader photo + name + "Trip Lead" label
- Phone number visible

"I'm Committed" CTA button:

- Full width
- Coral fill
- Fixed at bottom of screen

screen 3 — Commitment flow (modal sheet)

Triggered by: tapping "I'm Committed"

Step 1 — transport question:

- "Can you drive to the trailhead?"
- Two large tap options: "Yes, I can drive" / "I need a ride"
- If yes → "How many total seats in your car including you?" (number selector 1–7)

- If no → goes straight to confirmation

Step 2 — confirmation:

- "You're in." (large, coral)
- Trip name
- Date
- "Your trip packet is now unlocked"
- Button: "View Trip Packet"

screen 4 — Trips tab

Purpose: Evan's active trip hub. Trips he's committed to + Q&A.

Header: "Your Trips"

Trip cards (committed):

- Hero photo thumbnail (left, square)
- Trip name
- Date
- Status pill: "Committed" / "Waitlisted"
- Days until trip countdown
- Arrow to Trip Packet

Tapping a trip → Trip Packet page:

Trip Packet page sections (scrollable):

- Hero image
- Trip name + date
- Section links (each taps into its own sub-page):
 - Itinerary (day-by-day)
 - Packing List
 - Food Plan + Allergens
 - Cost Breakdown
 - Meeting Location + Time
 - Safety Notes
 - FAQ
- Trip Lead contact card (name + phone)
- Committed members list (names + photos + drive/need ride status)

Q&A section (below all sections):

- "Questions for the trip lead"
 - Previous Q&As visible to all committed members
 - Text input: "Ask a question..."
 - Posted questions show: member avatar + name + question + leader answer below
 - Leader answers labeled "Trip Lead" in coral
-

screen 5 — Create tab

Purpose: Start a trip or get inspired.

Two tabs inside Create:

- Start a Trip (default)
- Inspiration

Start a Trip tab:

Form fields:

- Event name
- Date + time (date picker)
- Location (maps search input)
- Event type selector (Day Trip / Overnight / Off Campus / Social / Lessons / Meeting)
- Photo upload
- Which clubs to share to (multi-select chips)
- Description (text area)

Below form — prominent web nudge banner:

- Coral background card
- "Planning a full club trip? Build the complete trip packet on web — itinerary, packing list, gear, carpool, and more."
- Button: "Open on Web →"

Publish button:

- Full width, coral
- "Post Community Event" or "Save Trip Draft" depending on context

Inspiration tab:

- Grid of past kindred club trips (big photos, 2-column)
- Each card: trip photo, trip name, club name, date, member count

- Tapping one → full preview of that past trip
 - Bottom sheet CTA: "Use as template on web →" (coral button)
-

screen 6 — Communities tab

Purpose: Club discovery directory.

Header: "Communities" Subheader: "Outdoor clubs at Cal Poly SLO"

Club cards (full width, big photo):

- Hero photo (club landscape or activity photo)
- Club name (large, overlaid on photo bottom)
- Tagline (small, muted, below photo)
- Member count

Tapping a club → Club Detail page:

- Full bleed club hero photo
 - Club name + tagline
 - Member count + upcoming trips count
 - "Join Circle" button (coral, full width)
 - About section
 - Leaders section (avatar row with names + roles)
 - Upcoming Trips section (horizontal scroll cards)
 - Past Trips photo gallery (grid)
-

screen 7 — Yours tab (also Profile)

Purpose: Evan's profile + his trip history.

Header:

- Evan's profile photo (large circle, top center)
- Name below
- School year + major (muted)
- Clubs row (small circle avatars of each club he's in)
- Trips completed count + badge count (two stat pills)

Three horizontal tabs below profile header:

- Current
- Saved

- Past

Current tab:

- Trips Evan has committed to
- Card: photo thumbnail + trip name + date + days until + "View Packet" link
- Waitlisted trips labeled separately

Saved tab:

- Trips Evan is watching
- Card: photo + trip name + date + "Signup opens in X days" label
- Notification bell toggle per saved trip

Past tab:

- Memory cards — one per completed trip
- Card: full photo + trip name + date + who he went with (avatar row)
- Subtle 🔥 icon between profiles that have 3+ shared trips

Below tabs — profile details section:

- Emergency contact
- Phone number
- Waiver status (green checkmark or red pending)
- Membership status
- Achievements/badges grid

design system

Colors:

Primary coral: #FA8E73

Dark coral: #D85A30

Background: #FFFFFF

Surface: #F8F6F3

Text primary: #1A1A1A

Text muted: #888780

Border: #E8E4DF

Success green: #639922

Typography:

- Display/headings: something with character — not Inter, not SF Pro defaults. Editorial, slightly warm.

- Body: clean, readable, 16px base
- Labels/chips: 12–13px, medium weight
- Sentence case always — never ALL CAPS

Components:

- Cards: white background, subtle border, rounded corners (16px)
- Chips/pills: 8px radius, 12px padding horizontal
- Buttons: full width primary = coral fill, white text, 14px radius. Secondary = outlined coral.
- Bottom sheet modals for flows (commitment, filters)
- Tab bars: pill-style active state in coral
- Avatars: circle, stacked with overlap for group displays

Spacing:

- 16px horizontal page margins
- 12px gap between cards
- 24px section spacing

Icons:

- Outline style (Tabler or similar)
- Never filled unless active state

Motion:

- Subtle. Card tap scales down slightly (0.97). Sheet modals spring up. No excessive animation.

screens to generate in this order

1. Home — Trips tab (default state, 3 trip cards visible)
2. Trip Detail — pre-commitment (Sykes Hot Springs)
3. Commitment flow modal (drive question + confirmation)
4. Trip Packet page (post-commitment, Sykes)
5. Trips tab (Evan's active trips + Q&A)
6. Create — Start a Trip tab
7. Create — Inspiration tab
8. Communities tab (club directory)
9. Club Detail page (Field Studies Club)

10. Yours tab — Current sub-tab
11. Yours tab — Past sub-tab (with memory cards)
12. Onboarding — sign up flow (name, school email, photo, clubs, experience level)

constraints

- iOS only, iPhone 14 Pro dimensions (393 x 852pt)
- No payments UI
- No visible AI features
- No route maps in V1
- No DMs — phone number handles real communication
- Trip channels auto-archive (no need to show archive UI)
- Gear Shed is view-only, low priority — build last
- Web portal is separate — do not design web screens here

tone reminder

kindred is warm, earned, not performative. The UI should feel like something a Cal Poly outdoor kid would actually trust. Not startup-y. Not corporate. Not REI catalog. The coral is the personality — let it breathe without overwhelming everything.

what would be the key issues we'd face with this Moderation / reporting

May 30

Great question to think through before building. Here's the full honest breakdown.

the core problem

kindred is a trust-based community app where real people share phone numbers, show up to remote locations together, and join trips with strangers. The stakes for moderation failures are higher than a typical social app — a bad actor isn't just annoying, they could end up alone on a trail with someone vulnerable.

issue 1 — phone number exposure

This is your biggest immediate risk. You decided phone numbers are visible to all committed members on a trip. That's the right call for connection — but it means:

A bad actor commits to any trip and instantly harvests real phone numbers from every member on that trip. There's no friction. No relationship required.

What breaks: Evan's number gets shared to someone he never met, who never showed up, who signed up just to collect contacts.

Fix options: only show phone numbers to members who actually attended (post-trip unlock), or show numbers only after a leader marks attendance, or let members opt in to showing their number vs just their name.

issue 2 — community event abuse

You made community events go live immediately with no approval — anyone can post, leaders can remove. That's fast and low-friction, which is right. But:

Someone posts "bonfire at Grover Beach Saturday 7pm" with predatory intent. It looks identical to a real community event. It goes live immediately to every club member.

What breaks: Evan shows up. Nobody else does. Or worse.

Fix options: require a .edu email to post community events, add a one-tap "report this event" button that auto-notifies a club admin, or add a soft delay (15 minutes) where the poster can't see who's viewing before it goes fully live.

issue 3 — no identity verification

Right now anyone with a .edu email is in. But .edu emails are easy to get, sometimes shared, and don't verify club membership.

What breaks: non-members join club trips, people create fake profiles, someone who got kicked out of a club re-registers with a different email.

Fix options: club leader manually approves new members before they can commit to trips, or Supabase role system gates trip access to verified circle members only.

issue 4 — the Q&A section

You built Q&A as a public thread visible to all committed members. That's useful — but it's also the first place conflict will surface publicly.

What breaks: a frustrated member posts something aggressive in the Q&A, a leader responds poorly, other committed members see it and lose trust in the trip or the club.

Fix options: leaders can delete Q&A posts, a report button on individual Q&A threads, Q&A is read-only for everyone except the poster and leader (no member-to-member replies).

issue 5 — trip channels (when you build them)

Even stripped-down trip channels become a moderation surface the moment two people disagree about carpool logistics or someone drops out last minute and people get frustrated.

What breaks: a hostile message right before a trip poisons the group dynamic before anyone even hits the trail.

Fix options: leaders have admin controls in trip channels, a simple report button routes to club admin, channels are automatically read-only 48 hours after trip ends (before the 30-day archive).

issue 6 — the 🔥 mechanic

The fire emoji appears quietly between two profiles after 3 shared trips. Beautiful mechanic — but:

What breaks: someone strategically commits to trips they never attend just to accumulate 🔥 connections and appear trustworthy. It becomes a fake social signal.

Fix options: 🔥 only unlocks after leader marks both people as attended — not just committed. Attendance confirmation is the gate, not signup.

issue 7 — leader power with no accountability

Leaders can remove community events, manage RSVPs, take attendance, see phone numbers. That's a lot of power for a 20-year-old club officer.

What breaks: a leader removes a community event they personally dislike, blocks certain members from trips, or misuses the phone number visibility.

Fix options: an admin tier above leaders (you, as the kindred operator) has override controls, leader actions are logged in Supabase with timestamps, members can report a leader action to kindred support.

the minimum you need in V1

You don't need a full trust and safety team. But you need these four things before launch:

1. Report button on every trip, event, and profile. One tap routes to you directly. You are the moderator at Cal Poly scale.
 2. Attendance-gated phone number visibility. Don't show numbers until the leader marks the trip complete. Reduces harvesting risk dramatically.
 3. .edu email required for all accounts. Simple gate that cuts most bad faith signups.
 4. Leader remove + you have override. Leaders moderate their club. You moderate leaders.
- Clean chain.

Everything else — formal reporting flows, trust scores, content moderation queues — is a V2 problem when you have scale that justifies it. At Cal Poly with 5 clubs you can handle edge cases

manually. The goal in V1 is to make the obvious bad stuff impossible, not to build a moderation system for problems you haven't seen yet.

what software does csu already pay for?

May 30

Searched the web

Searched the web

Here's what Cal Poly already pays for — and what it means for kindred.

what every Cal Poly student gets free

Adobe Creative Cloud — free for all Cal Poly students. Full suite: Photoshop, Illustrator, Premiere Pro, InDesign, and more. Cal Poly

Microsoft 365 — full web-based suite including Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneDrive, and SharePoint, plus five free downloads for personal Mac and Windows devices. Calpoly

Zoom — for classes, club meetings, and office hours. Cal Poly

Canvas — Cal Poly's learning management system, available on desktop and mobile. Cal Poly

AppStream (Virtual Computer Labs) — cloud-based streaming of specialized academic software through a browser, previously only available in on-campus labs. Cal Poly Pomona

Antivirus — Sophos and Jamf Protect (listed on ITS software page).

Adobe Sign — eSignature and forms tool, included with the Adobe license.

what this means for kindred specifically

Three things jump out:

Waivers are already solved. Adobe Sign is free for every Cal Poly student and staff member. You don't need to build waiver infrastructure in V1 — leaders can send and collect signed waivers through Adobe Sign and just link to it from the trip packet. Check the box, move on.

OneDrive/SharePoint is already there. Clubs that currently share files, gear lists, or trip documents across a team already have a tool for it. kindred doesn't need to solve file storage — link out to OneDrive from the trip packet for anything document-heavy.

Zoom is the meeting tool. If a club wants to do a pre-trip info session, Zoom is already in every leader's pocket. kindred can surface a Zoom link in the trip packet without building video infrastructure.

The gap kindred fills is exactly what none of these cover — trip discovery, RSVP, carpool coordination, the social layer, and the post-trip memory. Adobe and Microsoft don't care that Evan hasn't shown up yet. Canvas is for classes. Zoom is for meetings. None of them know who Evan is or that Sykes Hot Springs is happening in three weeks.

That's your white space. Still completely unoccupied by anything Cal Poly already pays for.
who to charge for the use of this tho?

May 30

This is the most important business model question you haven't answered yet. Let me lay out the real options.

the three possible people to charge

1. the clubs

Charge the club a flat monthly or annual SaaS fee.

Pros — clubs have ASI budget, one decision-maker (the president), you only need 5 yeses to have 5 paying customers, clean B2B relationship.

Cons — outdoor club budgets are tiny, typically \$500–2000/year total, a software line item competes with gear and trip subsidies, president turns over every year so you re-pitch annually.

Real number: \$50–150/month per club is probably the ceiling before it feels like too much of their budget.

2. the school / ASI

Pitch Cal Poly's Associated Students Inc. or Student Affairs as an institutional license.

Pros — one deal covers all clubs, real budget (\$\$\$), procurement people who are used to writing software checks, makes kindred the official campus outdoor platform.

Cons — 6–18 month procurement cycle, IT security review, legal, you'd need to be more polished and proven before they take you seriously, kills your speed.

Real number: \$5,000–20,000/year institutional deal. Life-changing at early stage but takes forever.

3. the members (Evan)

Freemium — basic access free, premium features paid.

Pros — scales with users not clubs, doesn't require institutional buy-in, familiar model Evan understands.

Cons — what do you gate behind a paywall without breaking the core experience? Charging Evan to join trips is wrong. Charging for profile badges is weak. Hard to find a natural premium tier.

Real number: \$3–5/month or \$20/year. Low conversion rates on consumer apps at this stage.

the honest answer

Don't charge anyone in V1. Here's why.

You have zero leverage yet. Clubs won't pay for software they haven't tried. ASI won't write a check for an unproven app. And charging Evan before he's even shown up to his first trip is exactly the wrong move.

Your job in Fall 2025 is to prove the first-timer show-up rate. Get Evan to Sykes. Get the 🔥 to appear. Get club leaders to stop using Google Forms. That's the proof that makes charging possible.

V2 monetization — after you have proof:

The cleanest model is a club SaaS fee with an ASI enterprise deal as the endgame. Charge clubs \$99/month once they've run 3+ trips on kindred and leaders are hooked. Then walk into ASI with receipts — "5 clubs, 200 members, 40 trips run, here's the first-timer show-up rate" — and pitch a campus-wide license that makes kindred free for every club.

That's the path. Free → club pays → campus pays. Each stage funds the next.

theres several add on feature on top of what we already have - this is the final goal, will combine all sorts, (new pormlem: clubs advertise thorough instagram alone - issue: not everyone has instarram on their phone because it is too adictive) - well how selse to get the word out about your club meeting or meetups as a freshman: kindred)

1 - Webapp for planning

2- native money transfer (using stripe or something similar)

3- Messaging service

May 30

This is the full vision now. Let me map it out clearly before we talk about how to get there.

what kindred actually is at full scale

It's not just a trip planner. It's the operating system for outdoor clubs — the single place where everything a club does lives. Discovery, planning, communication, money, membership.

And the Instagram problem you just named is real and underserved. Freshmen who deleted Instagram (or never downloaded it because it's too addictive) have no way to discover what's happening on campus outside of walking past a flyer. kindred solves that. It's the campus outdoor feed for people who opted out of the algorithm.

the full product at maturity

Layer 1 — what you're building now (V1) Trip discovery, commitment flow, trip packet, Q&A, club directory, community events, inspiration library. The core. Proves Evan shows up.

Layer 2 — Web portal for planning Full trip builder for leaders. Club-specific flows. Itinerary, packing list, food plan, cost breakdown, carpool management, RSVP dashboard, attendance tracking. The ops layer that makes leaders' lives actually easier.

Layer 3 — Native money transfer Stripe or similar. Trip fees collected in-app. Club dues paid in-app. No more Venmo chaos, no more cash at the trailhead, no more chasing people for \$20. This is where kindred becomes financially indispensable to clubs — and where your revenue model unlocks naturally (take 1–2% of transactions).

Layer 4 — Messaging Trip channels auto-created on publish. Club announcement channels. The Slack-for-outdoor-clubs layer that replaces GroupMe permanently. Contextual, trip-linked, auto-archived. Not general chat — structured communication around real events.

the Instagram replacement angle

This is actually your strongest freshman acquisition argument and you should make it explicit in your pitch.

The problem isn't that clubs have bad content. It's that the content lives on a platform optimized for addiction that a growing number of Gen Z students are deliberately avoiding. Beeper, Dumb Phone movement, screen time anxiety — this is real and accelerating.

kindred is the non-algorithmic alternative. No infinite scroll. No ads. No engagement bait. Just — here's what's happening outside this week. Come or don't.

That's a genuinely different value proposition from Instagram and it's one a Dean of Students or a wellness office would actually fund.

the business model this unlocks

Layer	Who pays	How	When
Trip discovery + planning	Free	—	Now
Web portal	Clubs	\$99/month SaaS	After 3+ trips proven
Money transfer	Transaction	1.5% per payment	When Stripe goes live
Messaging	Bundled with portal	—	Included in club fee

Campus license	ASI/school	\$10–20k/year	After multi-club proof
----------------	------------	---------------	------------------------

Transaction fees on Layer 3 are actually your most scalable revenue. If 5 clubs run 20 trips/year at \$25/person with 20 people each — that's \$50,000 in payments processed, \$750–1000 in fees. Across 20 schools that's real money without charging anyone a subscription.

the build order this implies

You already know V1. Here's what comes after:

V2 — Web portal (next semester after launch) Prove leaders will use it. Get clubs off Google Forms completely.

V3 — Stripe money transfer (after web portal has traction) This is the stickiest feature you can build. Once club money flows through kindred, clubs will never leave.

V4 — Messaging (after money is proven) By this point clubs are fully on kindred. Messaging is the last nail in GroupMe's coffin.

V5 — Multi-campus (after Cal Poly is locked) UC Santa Barbara, UC San Diego, Colorado, Utah. Outdoor culture campuses first.

The Instagram observation is the product insight that ties all of this together. kindred isn't competing with Instagram — it's the place you go instead of Instagram to find out what's happening outside. That's a completely different product with a completely different relationship to the user.

Want to lock the V2 web portal scope next, or talk through the Stripe integration?

wait why only outdoor clubs again?

May 30

Exactly the right question to ask right now. Let me think through this honestly.

why you said outdoor clubs only — originally

The reasoning was sharp at the time. Your unfair advantage is specific — you built the manual version of kindred for outdoor clubs. You know the logistics, the trip types, the Mayas, the leaders. Outdoor clubs are underserved because they're operationally complex in ways generic club tools ignore. Staying specific meant staying credible.

And the brand risk was real — the second kindred becomes the chess club app, the coral palette and the trail dust and the 🔥 after 3 shared hikes loses its meaning.

why that reasoning is worth revisiting now

You just added three layers that change the equation completely.

Money transfer is club-agnostic. Stripe doesn't care if you're collecting \$25 for a backpacking trip or \$15 for a pottery club supply fee. The payment infrastructure works for everyone.

The Instagram problem isn't outdoor-specific. Every club on campus — dance, cooking, pre-med, photography — has the same problem. Their content lives on Instagram. Freshmen who opt out of Instagram miss everything. kindred as a campus discovery layer solves that for all of them.

The messaging layer is universal. GroupMe and Slack pain exists in every club, not just outdoor ones.

the real question

Are you building a vertical product — deep, specific, owning outdoor — or a horizontal platform — broad, campus-wide, owning club life?

Both are real businesses. But they're different companies with different moats.

Vertical outdoor — you win because nobody else understands the trip packet, the carpool problem, the permit chaos, the gear shed. You go deep where others are shallow. Brand stays strong. Expansion is geographic — more campuses, same clubs.

Horizontal campus platform — you win because you're the only place all club life lives. Network effects are massive — Evan uses kindred for hiking AND cooking AND pre-med club, so he's in it every day. Expansion is vertical — more club types, same campuses. This is how you get the ASI institutional deal.

my honest take

Start vertical, design horizontal.

The product decisions you've made — trip packets, carpool coordination, the commitment flow — those are outdoor-specific right now. But the underlying architecture — clubs, members, events, channels, payments, discovery — is completely club-agnostic.

Build kindred for outdoor clubs at Cal Poly. Prove it works. Then when a cooking club president sees what Field Studies is using and asks "can we get this?" — the answer is yes, and you charge them for it.

You don't pivot. You expand. Outdoor clubs are the wedge, campus life is the market.

The brand question is the only real tension. Does kindred stay coral and trail-dust when the chess club signs up? Maybe by then the brand has evolved naturally. Or maybe outdoor clubs are always the flagship and other clubs use a whitelabeled version. That's a V3 problem.

For now: outdoor only. But build nothing that locks you out of expanding later.

I think messaging should be in V1 lets try right now real quick - develop ui given all we talked about in this chat all the decisions and ask me questions about layout - home/create/messaging/communities/personal

May 30

New nav locked:

Home / Create / Messaging / Communities / Personal

Few quick questions before building the UI.

Q: Messaging tab – what does the main screen look like when Evan opens it?

A: Split – club switcher top, conversations below

Q: What channel types exist in V1?

A: each club on slider up above, each club has - members only, random, general, then below is another bubble for trip specific channels. DMs surpass all clubs (its tied to user not to people)

Q: Messaging screen color feel?

A: we can talk about ui later - also dont develop anything yet - just keep talking

May 30

Got it, not building yet. Let me play back what you just described to make sure I have it right.

Messaging structure:

Top – club switcher (horizontal scroll) Field Studies / Surf Club / Alpine Club / Climbing Club

Below – channels for selected club:

- Members Only
- Random
- General

Then a separate section below:

- Trip Channels (bubble/section header) – one per active trip, auto-created on publish

Completely separate – DMs

- Not tied to any club
- Tied to the user
- Lives outside the club switcher entirely – probably its own section at the top or a separate entry point

That's a clean architecture. Slack's workspace model for clubs, iMessage's DM model for people. The two never mix.

One thing to pressure test before we move on:

Q: Where does Evan access DMs — how does he get there?

A: Separate DM icon in the header top right

Q: Who can Evan DM?

A: Anyone on kindred at Cal Poly

May 30

Clean. DMs are universal — kindred becomes the campus outdoor network, not just a club tool. That's a bigger vision and it supports the Instagram replacement angle perfectly.

Two more before we're done with messaging:

Q: What can Evan send in a channel or DM in V1?

A: Text + photos + reactions only

Q: How does Evan know he has unread messages?

A: Push notification + badge

May 30

Locked. Messaging is fully defined. Here's the complete picture:

Messaging — fully locked

Header: "Messaging" wordmark left, DM icon top right (opens universal DM inbox, anyone on kindred Cal Poly)

Club switcher: horizontal scroll pills — Field Studies / Surf Club / Alpine Club / Climbing Club

Below switcher — selected club channels:

- Members Only
- Random
- General

Separate section below — Trip Channels:

- One per active trip, auto-created when leader publishes
- Archived 30 days post-trip

DMs: separate inbox via top right icon, not tied to any club, any kindred user

Message content: text + photos + reactions only. No files, no links preview, no threads in V1.

Notifications: push notification + red badge count on the tab bar icon

Messaging is now a V1 feature. Nav is locked:

Home / Create / Messaging / Communities / Personal

Ready to keep going? Options:

Q: What's next?

A: Start talking UI and build

May 30

Let's lock the visual direction before anything gets built. A few fast questions.

Q: Base color mode?

A: no creme whatsoever - should be white - isntagram, slack, strava and groupme are great combos. Font should be simple not bulky

Q: Overall UI personality?

A: Rounded and friendly — like Instagram

Q: How should navigation and modals feel?

A: Mix — sheets for quick actions, full screen for deep pages

May 30

Locked. Clean white, coral, rounded, Instagram-native feel. Now the most important visual decision before building:

Q: Font — which direction feels right for kindred?

A: SF pro

Q: Bottom nav active state — how does Evan know which tab he's on?

A: Coral fill on active, gray outline on inactive

Q: Home screen header — what sits at the very top?

A: kindred wordmark top left, then notification and dms up above

May 30

Locked. All visual decisions made. Here's the full design system before we build:

Typography: SF Pro — clean, native, invisible Colors: White base, #FA8E73 coral, gray muted text, pure black for headers Nav: Coral fill active, gray outline inactive, 5 tabs Header: kindred wordmark top left, notifications + DM icon top right Cards: Rounded, white, Instagram full-width Modals: Bottom sheets for quick actions, full screen for deep pages Vibe: Instagram rounded + AllTrails information density + Strava energy

Ready to build. Which screen first?

concsolodate this entire chat to move to anohter claude chat - keep all contxt and my decisions

May 30

kindred — master context document

paste this at the start of any new claude chat

what kindred is

kindred (always lowercase) is a social outdoor community app for college students. It is a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Not a dating app. Not a fitness tracker. Not performative. The place outdoor clubs live.

Tagline: find your people outside Primary user: Evan Turly — Cal Poly SLO freshman, grew up hiking, signed up for the outdoor club email list during orientation, hasn't shown up yet because he doesn't know anyone Founder: former Director of Trips for Cal Poly SLO's largest outdoor club (now a nonprofit). Built the manual version of kindred already across Google Forms, GroupMe, Instagram, and email. Technical stack: React Native + Supabase.

the problem

College students have no trusted non-romantic way to find their people through shared outdoor experience. Club content lives on Instagram — a platform a growing number of Gen Z students are deliberately avoiding. Freshmen who opt out of Instagram miss everything. kindred is the non-algorithmic alternative. No infinite scroll. No ads. No engagement bait. Just — here's what's happening outside this week.

It also replaces the duct-taped mess clubs currently use: Instagram + Google Forms + GroupMe + email + Slack.

brand

- Name: kindred (lowercase always)
 - Tagline: find your people outside
 - Primary color: coral #FA8E73
 - Feel: Patagonia people, Strava folk, Bon Iver cabin, dog-eared field notebook
 - Not rugged-bro. Not startup-y. Not REI catalog. Warm, earned, real.
 - References: AllTrails information density + Instagram social feel + Strava energy
-

terminology

- Members = kindred
 - Groups = circles
 - Committing to a trip = "I'm Committed" (never "spark in" — sounds too 420)
 - 🔥 appears quietly between two profiles after 3 shared trips — attendance-gated, never announced, just discovered
 - Trip channels auto-archive 30 days post-trip
-

launch plan

First clubs (all at once, Fall 2025):

- Cal Poly Outdoor Club (Field Studies nonprofit)

- Surf Club
- Alpine Club
- Climbing Club
- Hiking/nature club

Pitch targets: club presidents + officers as a group Ask: replace Google Forms signups + replace GroupMe coordination First canonical trip: Sykes Hot Springs, Big Sur — multi-day backpacking, 10 miles, permit required, carpool-dependent Key metric: first-timer show-up rate

architecture — two surfaces

Mobile app (React Native, iOS first) For everyone. Members browse, commit, message, discover. Community events created here. Trip skeletons started here with heavy nudge to finish on web. Web portal (Next.js) For leaders and anyone planning a real trip. Full trip packet builder, club-specific flows, RSVP management, carpool assignment, attendance tracking, club channel management. Club leaders get club-specific login with elevated permissions.

three types of content

1. Official Club Trip — leader-published via web portal, full packet, shows in main Home feed
2. Community Event — anyone posts on mobile, lightweight (name/date/location/photo/clubs), goes live immediately, leaders can remove it, shows in Community Events tab
3. Personal Trip Skeleton — anyone starts on mobile, heavy nudge to finish on web

bottom navigation — locked

Home / Create / Messaging / Communities / Personal

page 1 — Home

Two tabs inside: Trips (default) / Community Events

Filter row 1 — club switcher (horizontal scroll chips): All Clubs / Field Studies / Surf Club / Alpine Club / Climbing Club

Filter row 2 — event type chips: All / Day Trip / Overnight / Off Campus / Social / Lessons / Meeting

Trip card (full width, Instagram-style):

- Hero photo (16:9, rounded corners)

- Club name (coral, overlay on photo)
- Spots left badge (white pill, top right of photo)
- Trip name (large, bold)
- Location/destination (muted, pin icon)
- Date (muted, calendar icon)
- Beginner-friendly badge (green pill, when applicable)

Community Events tab:

- Same card structure, lighter
- No difficulty, no spots counter
- Shows who posted + "Anyone can join" label

Header: kindred wordmark top left, notification bell + DM icon top right

page 2 — Trip Detail (most important screen)

Pre-commitment Evan sees:

- Full bleed hero image (parallax)
- Club badge overlaid on photo
- Trip name (large, bold)
- Location, date range, difficulty chip, mileage
- Cost estimate (visible before committing)
- Beginner-friendly badge
- Who's going — full list, names + photos, count
- Leader card — photo, name, "Trip Lead", phone number
- "I'm Committed" button (coral, fixed bottom)

"I'm Committed" flow (bottom sheet modal):

- Can you drive? → Yes / I need a ride
- If yes → how many total seats including you? (1–7 selector)
- Auto-confirmed after answering
- Confirmation screen: "You're in." + "View Trip Packet" button

Post-commitment — Trip Packet (separate full screen page):

- Hero image + trip name + date
- Section links (each opens sub-page):
 - Itinerary (day-by-day)

- Packing List
- Food Plan + Allergens
- Cost Breakdown
- Meeting Location + Time
- Safety Notes
- FAQ
- Trip Lead contact card (name + phone)
- Committed members list (names + photos + drive/need ride status)
- Q&A section — all committed members can see all Q&As, questions directed to trip lead, text input at bottom

page 3 — Create

Two tabs inside:

Start a Trip tab:

- Fields: event name, date/time, location, event type selector, photo upload, which clubs to share to, description
- Prominent web nudge banner (coral): "Planning a full club trip? Build the complete trip packet on web →"
- Publish button: "Post Community Event" or "Save Trip Draft"

Inspiration tab:

- Grid of past kindred club trips (big photos, 2-column)
- Each card: trip photo, trip name, club name, date, member count
- Tap → full preview → bottom sheet CTA: "Use as template on web →"
- Purpose: social proof + conversion funnel to web portal

page 4 — Messaging

Header: "Messaging" left, DM icon top right

Club switcher (horizontal scroll pills): Field Studies / Surf Club / Alpine Club / Climbing Club

Below switcher — channels for selected club:

- Members Only
- Random
- General

Separate section below — Trip Channels:

- One per active trip, auto-created when leader publishes
- Committed members auto-added
- Archived 30 days after trip date

DMs (accessed via top right icon):

- Separate from all clubs
- Any kindred user at Cal Poly can be DM'd
- Not tied to clubs

Message content: text + photos + reactions only Notifications: push notification + red badge count on tab bar icon

page 5 — Communities

Purpose: club discovery directory

Club cards (full width, big photo):

- Hero photo
- Club name (overlaid bottom)
- Tagline (muted, below photo)
- Member count

Club Detail page (tap into):

- Full bleed hero photo
- Club name + tagline
- Member count + upcoming trips count
- "Join Circle" button (coral, full width)
- About section
- Leaders (avatar row, names + roles)
- Upcoming Trips (horizontal scroll cards)
- Past Trips photo gallery (grid)

page 6 — Personal (also Yours)

Profile header:

- Profile photo (large circle, top center)
- Name, school year, major (muted)

- Clubs row (small circle avatars)
- Two stat pills: trips completed + badge count

Three horizontal tabs:

Current:

- Committed trips + waitlisted trips
- Card: photo thumbnail + trip name + date + days until + "View Packet" link

Saved:

- Watchlist trips
- "Signup opens in X days" label
- Notification bell toggle per trip

Past:

- Memory cards — full photo + trip name + date + who he went with (avatar row)
- 🔥 between profiles with 3+ shared trips (attendance-gated)

Profile details section below tabs:

- Emergency contact
- Phone number
- Waiver status (green check or red pending)
- Membership status
- Achievements/badges grid

web portal — leader tools

Access: club leaders only, club-specific login, elevated permissions inside same portal

Build here:

- Full trip packet (itinerary, packing list, food plan, cost breakdown, FAQ, safety notes)
- Club-specific flows (surf lessons ≠ overnight backpacking ≠ alpine climb)
- Capacity + waitlist settings, carpool settings, difficulty, publish/draft toggle

Manage on mobile post-publish:

- RSVP list, carpool assignment, announcements, attendance day-of

Draft state: mobile skeletons appear prominently in web portal — "You have 2 unfinished trips"

design system — locked

Font: SF Pro (native iOS, clean, invisible) Base: white backgrounds, no cream whatsoever

Primary: coral #FA8E73 Dark coral: #D85A30 Surface: #F8F6F3 Text primary: #1A1A1A Text muted: #888780 Border: #E8E4DF Success: #639922

Nav: coral fill on active tab, gray outline on inactive Cards: white, rounded corners (16px), subtle border Buttons: full width primary = coral fill, white text, 14px radius Modals: bottom sheets for quick actions, full screen for deep pages Chips/pills: 8px radius, 12px horizontal padding Icons: outline style, never filled except active state Motion: subtle — card tap scales 0.97, sheets spring up Spacing: 16px page margins, 12px card gap, 24px section spacing Tone: sentence case always, never ALL CAPS

moderation — decisions made

- Report button on every trip, event, and profile (routes to you)
- Phone numbers visible only after leader marks attendance (not at commit)
- .edu email required for all accounts
- Leaders moderate their club, you override leaders
- 🔥 only unlocks after attendance confirmed — not just commitment
- Community events live immediately, leaders can remove
- Q&A visible to all committed members on that trip

what is NOT in V1

- Payments / Stripe (V3)
- Android (iOS first)
- Route tracking / fitness stats
- Gear checkout/reservation (Gear Shed view-only)
- AI visible to user (invisible infrastructure only)
- Web portal (V2 — after mobile proven)
- Multi-campus (V5 — after Cal Poly locked)
- Full moderation queue (manual at Cal Poly scale)

full product vision — build order

Phase	What	When
-------	------	------

V1	Mobile app — full feature set above	Fall 2025
V2	Web portal — leader trip builder	Spring 2026
V3	Stripe — native payments, dues, trip fees	After web proven
V4	Messaging hardening — threads, search	After V3
V5	Multi-campus expansion	After Cal Poly locked

business model

- V1: free
- V2: clubs pay \$99/month SaaS after 3+ trips proven
- V3: 1.5% transaction fee on all payments processed
- Endgame: ASI/campus institutional license \$10–20k/year

the one thing

Every product decision filters through: does this help Evan show up?

Here's your consolidated decisions document — updated with the messaging decisions from this conversation: kindred — complete product decisions document the product Name: kindred (always lowercase) Tagline: find your people outside What it is: a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Not a

pasted

you know exactly what needs to get done and all the decisions I've made. Generate a propmt to plug into notion to organize all these tasks. Each notion page conitaing a new theme within the website. It shold contain to-do list and explicit content and rough time estimate - and thoughts to give background. to do list and essential to non essential and milestiones - almsot gamify it. USe minor context from my other chat (dont use this as the source of turth tho - our current chat is more recnt)

May 30

kindred — Notion Setup Prompt

Copy and paste this entire prompt into a new Notion AI block or use it to manually scaffold your workspace.

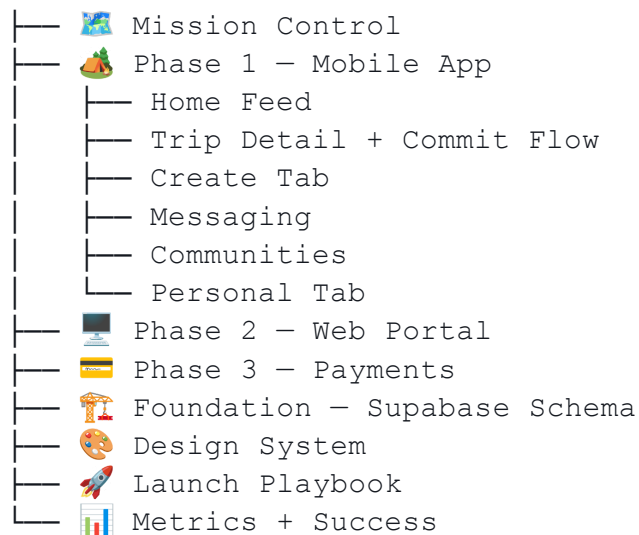
prompt

Build a Notion project workspace for kindred — a mobile app (React Native + Supabase) for outdoor clubs at Cal Poly SLO. The founder is a solo technical builder with minimal coding experience but high product clarity. The goal is to ship a working MVP by Fall 2025.

Create the following pages and subpages exactly as described. Each page should feel like a gamified mission brief — not a boring task list. Use progress indicators, priority tiers, and milestone markers throughout.

workspace structure

kindred HQ



page 1 — 🗺️ Mission Control

Purpose: the one page that orients everything. Open this every morning.

Sections:

The one sentence

kindred is a friendship engine disguised as a trip planner. Every decision filters through: does this help Evan show up?

Current phase

Phase 1 — Mobile App MVP. Target: Fall 2025 launch with 5 Cal Poly outdoor clubs.

5 clubs to launch with Checklist:

- Field Studies (nonprofit — founder's club, no pitch needed)
- Cal Poly Outdoor Club
- Surf Club
- Alpine Club
- Climbing Club

Milestone tracker (gamified)

- Supabase schema complete

- Auth + roles working
- Admin can create a trip
- Member can see that trip
- Member can commit
- Admin sees commitment + carpool data
- Messaging channels live
- First real trip run on kindred
- First club signed on
- 5 clubs live
- 50 members active
- First 🔥 appears

The north star metric

First-timer show-up rate. Did Evan actually make it to Sykes?

page 2 — 🏠 Foundation — Supabase Schema

Background thought: This is the most important work you'll do. Every screen in the app is just a view on top of this data. Get the schema right and the app writes itself. Rush it and you'll rebuild it three times.

Time estimate: 1–2 weeks

Milestone: ☒ Admin creates trip → member sees it → member commits → admin sees commitment. If this loop works, everything works.

Essential (build first):

`profiles` table — id, name, email (.edu required), phone, photo_url, school_year, major, experience_level, emergency_contact, waiver_status, membership_status, created_at

`clubs` table — id, name, tagline, photo_url, created_at

`club_members` table — user_id, club_id, role (member/leader/admin), joined_at

`trips` table — id, club_id, leader_id, title, description, location, date_start, date_end, difficulty, mileage, cost_estimate, capacity, spots_left, type (official/community/skeleton), status (draft/published/archived), beginner_friendly, created_at

`trip_rsvps` table — id, trip_id, user_id, status (committed/waitlisted/attended), can_drive, seats_available, needs_ride, created_at

`trip_sections` table — trip_id, section_type (itinerary/packing/food/cost/safety/faq/meeting), content (rich text/JSON), created_at

`messages` table — id, channel_id, user_id, content, photo_url, created_at

`channels` table — id, trip_id, club_id, type (trip/announcement/general/members), archived_at

`reactions` table — message_id, user_id, emoji, created_at

`community_events` table — id, creator_id, club_ids (array), title, description, location, date, photo_url, status, created_at

`gear_items` table — id, club_id, name, category, quantity, condition, photo_url (view only V1)

`achievements` table — user_id, type, unlocked_at

Row Level Security rules:

- .edu email required at signup
- Members read published trips in their clubs
- Members create/update own RSVPs
- Members update own profile
- Leaders create/edit trips for their club
- Leaders view all RSVPs for their trips
- Leaders manage their club channels
- Admins manage everything
- Phone numbers visible only after trip marked attended

Non-essential (add later):

- `notifications` table
- `trip_templates` table (Inspiration tab)
- `fire_connections` table (🔥 tracking)
- `waivers` table

Storage buckets:

- trip-images
- profile-photos
- club-photos
- message-photos
- waivers (later)

page 3 — 🍌 Phase 1 — Mobile App

Background thought: iOS only. React Native. Evan's world is his phone. Every screen should ask — does this help Evan show up to Sykes Hot Springs?

Time estimate: 6–10 weeks total across all subpages

Bottom nav: Home / Create / Messaging / Communities / Personal

Milestone: ✅ Evan can download the app, find the Sykes trip, commit, see his carpool status, and message his trip crew. Nothing else matters until this works.

subpage — Home Feed

Background thought: This is the first thing Evan sees. It needs to feel alive — real trips, real photos, real spots left. If the feed is empty, Evan leaves. Seed it with real trips before launch.

Time estimate: 1 week

Essential:

- Two tabs — Trips / Community Events
- Club switcher (horizontal scroll chips) — All / Field Studies / Surf / Alpine / Climbing

Event type chips — All / Day Trip / Overnight / Off Campus / Social / Lessons / Meeting
Full-width Instagram-style trip cards

Card shows: hero photo, club name (coral overlay), spots left badge, trip name, location, date, beginner-friendly badge

Community Events tab — same cards, lighter, shows poster name, "Anyone can join"

Header: kindred wordmark left, notification bell + DM icon right

Tapping card → Trip Detail page

Non-essential:

Search functionality

Algorithmic sorting

"People you might meet" section

Featured/pinned trips

subpage — Trip Detail + Commit Flow

Background thought: The most important screen in the entire app. If Evan doesn't commit here, nothing else matters. Keep it clean before commitment. Unlock the good stuff after. The carpool question at commitment is the only data collection moment — don't add anything else here.

Time estimate: 1.5 weeks

Essential — pre-commitment:

Full bleed hero image with parallax

Club badge overlaid on photo

Trip name, location, date range, difficulty chip, mileage

Cost estimate visible before committing

Beginner-friendly badge

Full attendee list — names + photos + count

Leader card — photo, name, "Trip Lead", phone number

"I'm Committed" button (coral, fixed bottom)

Essential — commit flow (bottom sheet):

"Can you drive?" — Yes / I need a ride

If yes → seat selector (1–7)

Auto-confirm after answering

"You're in." confirmation screen

"View Trip Packet" button

Essential — Trip Packet (full screen, post-commit):

Section links: Itinerary, Packing List, Food + Allergens, Cost Breakdown, Meeting

Location, Safety Notes, FAQ

Each section links to its own sub-page

Trip Lead contact card (name + phone)

Committed members list (names, photos, drive/need ride status)

Q&A section — all committed members see all Q&As, text input at bottom, leader answers labeled in coral

Non-essential:

- Waitlist flow
- Trip map/route
- Weather integration
- Photo gallery from past trips

subpage — Create Tab

Background thought: Two jobs: start something real (community event) or get inspired to plan something bigger (and go to web). The Inspiration tab is a Trojan horse — it looks like content but it's a conversion funnel to the web portal. Every past trip card is an ad for finishing on web.

Time estimate: 1 week

Essential:

- Two tabs — Start a Trip / Inspiration

- Start a Trip: name, date/time, location, event type, photo upload, which clubs, description

- Prominent coral web nudge banner: "Planning a full club trip? Build the complete trip packet on web →"

- "Post Community Event" or "Save Trip Draft" publish button

- Inspiration tab: 2-column grid of past club trips

- Each card: photo, trip name, club, date, member count

- Tap → preview → "Use as template on web →" bottom sheet CTA

Non-essential:

- Draft saving on mobile

- Trip duplication

- AI trip description generator

subpage — Messaging

Background thought: Slack architecture, Instagram visual skin. kindred owns the coordination window around each trip — not general club chat (Slack/GroupMe own that). Trip channels auto-create, auto-populate, auto-archive. Evan never has to set anything up. DMs are universal — tied to the user not the club — because kindred is the campus outdoor network, not just a club tool.

Time estimate: 2 weeks (most complex V1 feature)

Essential:

- Header: "Messaging" left, DM icon top right

- Club switcher (horizontal scroll pills)

- Per club — three channels: Members Only, Random, General

- Separate section below — Trip Channels (one per active trip)

- Trip channels auto-created when leader publishes on web

- Committed members auto-added to trip channel

- Trip channels archived 30 days after trip date

- DM inbox (via top right icon) — any kindred user at Cal Poly

Message content: text + photos + reactions only

Push notification + red badge count on tab bar

Non-essential:

Message search

Thread replies

File attachments

Read receipts

Typing indicators

subpage — Communities

Background thought: Club discovery. This is how kindred becomes the Instagram replacement for outdoor clubs — Evan can browse every club on campus without having to follow anyone on a social network. Big photos, clean cards, one tap to learn more and join.

Time estimate: 0.5 weeks

Essential:

Full-width big photo club cards

Card: hero photo, club name (overlaid), tagline, member count

Club Detail page: full bleed photo, name, tagline, member + trip counts

"Join Circle" button (coral)

About section

Leaders row (avatars + names + roles)

Upcoming Trips (horizontal scroll)

Past Trips photo gallery (grid)

Non-essential:

Club search

Club categories/filters

Club social feed

subpage — Personal Tab

Background thought: Yours and Profile are the same tab. Evan's trips and his identity live in one place — like Instagram where your profile is also your content history. The 🔥 mechanic lives here and is attendance-gated — you don't earn it by signing up, you earn it by showing up.

Time estimate: 1 week

Essential:

Profile header: photo, name, year, major, clubs row, trips + badges stats

Three tabs: Current / Saved / Past

Current: committed + waitlisted trips, "View Packet" link per trip

Saved: watchlist trips, "Signup opens in X days", notification bell toggle

Past: memory cards — photo, trip name, date, who he went with (avatar row)

🔥 between profiles with 3+ shared attended trips

Profile details: emergency contact, phone, waiver status, membership status, achievements grid

Non-essential:

Public profile visible to others (V2)
Activity stats / miles hiked
Social following

page 4 — 🖨️ Phase 2 — Web Portal

Background thought: Leaders are operators. They're planning Sykes Hot Springs on a laptop at 11pm — permit logistics, carpool spreadsheet, gear list, cost breakdown. Mobile is too small for this. The web portal is where kindred earns its place in a leader's workflow. Build this after mobile is proven.

Time estimate: 4–6 weeks Target: Spring 2026

Milestone: ✅ Leader builds a complete Sykes trip packet on web in under 20 minutes without asking you for help.

Essential:

Club leader login (club-specific, elevated permissions)
Trip builder — all sections: basic info, itinerary, packing list, food + allergens, cost breakdown, safety notes, FAQ, meeting location
Club-specific trip templates (surf lessons ≠ overnight backpacking ≠ alpine climb)
Capacity + waitlist settings
Carpool assignment view (auto-organized from commit responses)
Publish / draft toggle
RSVP dashboard — full list, drive/need ride status, filters
Attendance marking (gates phone number visibility + 🔥)
Announcement sender
Mobile draft inbox — "You have 2 unfinished trips"

Non-essential:

Analytics dashboard
Multi-leader permissions
Club branding customization
Bulk member import

page 5 — 🏠 Phase 3 — Payments

Background thought: This is where kindred becomes financially indispensable. Once club money flows through kindred, clubs never leave. Trip fees, dues, gear deposits — all in one place.

Revenue model: 1.5% transaction fee. This replaces the Venmo chaos and ASI PayPal clunkiness completely. Don't touch this until the web portal is proven.

Time estimate: 3–4 weeks Target: After Spring 2026 web portal proven

Milestone: ✅ A club collects \$500 in trip fees through kindred without a single Venmo request.

Essential:

- Stripe integration
- Trip fee collection at commit flow
- Club dues payment
- Leader payout / club account
- Transaction history
- 1.5% fee logic
- Refund flow for cancelled trips

Non-essential:

- Gear deposits
- Split payment
- International payments

page 6 — 🎨 Design System

Background thought: Every screen should feel like the same app. Lock these decisions once, reference them everywhere. No cream. No clutter. White + coral + SF Pro.

Time estimate: 3 days (do this before building any screens)

Locked decisions:

- Font: SF Pro (native iOS)
- Base: pure white #FFFFFF, no cream
- Primary coral: #FA8E73
- Dark coral: #D85A30
- Surface: #F8F6F3
- Text primary: #1A1A1A
- Text muted: #888780
- Border: #E8E4DF
- Success green: #639922
- Nav: coral fill active, gray outline inactive
- Cards: white, 16px radius, subtle border
- Buttons: coral fill, white text, 14px radius
- Modals: bottom sheets (quick actions), full screen (deep pages)
- Icons: outline style, never filled except active
- Motion: card tap 0.97 scale, sheets spring up
- Spacing: 16px margins, 12px card gap, 24px sections
- Tone: sentence case always, never ALL CAPS

Screens to design in order:

- Home feed
- Trip Detail (pre-commit)
- Commit flow modal
- Trip Packet
- Messaging main screen
- DM inbox

- Trip channel view
- Communities directory
- Club Detail
- Personal tab (all 3 sub-tabs)
- Create tab (both tabs)
- Onboarding flow

page 7 — 🚀 Launch Playbook

Background thought: You have an unfair advantage — you're embedded in these clubs right now. Use it. Don't cold pitch. Walk in as the person who already built the manual version and is now giving them something better.

Time estimate: ongoing

Milestone: ☒ First real trip run entirely on kindred with zero Google Forms, zero GroupMe for coordination.

Pre-launch checklist:

- App runs on a real iPhone without crashing
- The Sykes commit flow works end to end
- Trip Packet is complete and readable
- Messaging channels auto-create on trip publish
- .edu email gate works
- Report button routes to you
- Phone numbers hidden until attendance marked

Pitch checklist (per club):

- Schedule meeting with president + officers
- Demo the Sykes trip flow live on your phone
- Show the carpool auto-organization
- Show the Trip Packet
- Ask: "What would you need to see to run your next trip on kindred?"
- Get one trip scheduled on kindred before leaving the meeting

Post-launch week 1:

- Watch every commit and flag anything broken
- Text every trip leader after their first trip
- Count first-timers who showed up
- Ask Evan (real freshman) what confused him

page 8 — 📊 Metrics + Success

Background thought: Don't measure everything. Measure the one thing. Did Evan show up? Everything else is noise until that's proven.

The one metric: first-timer show-up rate

Secondary metrics to track:

Commits per trip (target: 80%+ of capacity)
Commit-to-show-up rate (target: 75%+)
First-timer commit rate (how many are new members)
First-timer show-up rate (the one metric)
Repeat trip rate (did Evan come back?)
🔥 unlocks per month (friendship formation proxy)
Leader time saved per trip (qualitative, ask them)
Clubs still using Google Forms (target: zero by end of semester)

Milestone celebrations:

🌱 First commit on kindred
🔥 First 🔥 unlocked
🍲 First trip run entirely on kindred
👥 50 active members
🏄 3 clubs live
🌊 5 clubs live
💬 First time a leader says "I don't need GroupMe anymore"
🎓 End of semester — Evan came back for trip #3

relaistically - how long is this gonna take me?

May 30

Honest answer — longer than you want, shorter than you fear. But let me be real with you.

the hard truth first

You said minimal coding experience. React Native + Supabase is not a beginner stack. You're not just building an app — you're building a real-time messaging system, a role-based auth system, a carpool coordination tool, and a social feed simultaneously. Any one of those is a serious project. If you try to build everything in the Notion doc above before Fall 2025 — you will not ship.

realistic timeline by scenario

scenario 1 — you build it yourself, learning as you go

Total time: 12–18 months for full V1

- Supabase schema: 2–3 weeks
- Auth + roles working: 1–2 weeks
- Home feed (real data): 3–4 weeks
- Trip Detail + commit flow: 3–4 weeks
- Trip Packet: 2–3 weeks
- Messaging: 6–8 weeks alone — this is the hardest feature
- Communities: 2 weeks
- Personal tab: 2 weeks

- Create tab: 2 weeks
- Bug fixing, polish, TestFlight: 4–6 weeks

That's assuming you code every day for 2–4 hours. With classes, the club, and a life — realistically 18 months.

Fall 2025 is 3 months away. You cannot build all of this in 3 months learning as you go.

scenario 2 — you use Cursor aggressively + AI-assisted development

Total time: 4–6 months for a working MVP

Cursor changes the equation significantly. You can move 3–5x faster on boilerplate, schema generation, and component building if you know how to prompt it well. But you still hit walls — debugging, Supabase RLS rules, React Native navigation, real-time messaging — where AI help slows down and you need to actually understand what's happening.

Realistic Fall 2025 scope with Cursor: Home feed + Trip Detail + Commit flow + basic Trip Packet. That's it. That's 3 months of focused work.

Messaging gets cut to V1.5. Web portal is V2. That's the right call.

scenario 3 — you bring in a co-founder or contractor for 1–2 months

Total time: 2–3 months for a real MVP

One experienced React Native developer for 6–8 weeks while you own product, design, and the club relationships — and you could have something real by September. This is probably the fastest path to Fall 2025.

Cost: \$5–10k for a contractor, or find a technical co-founder who believes in the vision. Cal Poly's CS department has people who would build this for equity and the experience.

what I'd actually do

Cut the scope ruthlessly for Fall 2025. Here's what actually matters:

The only thing you need to prove in semester 1 is:

Leader publishes Sykes trip → Evan finds it → Evan commits → carpool organized → Evan shows up

That's five screens. Home feed, Trip Detail, Commit flow, Trip Packet, Personal tab (just Current). No messaging. No Communities page. No Create tab. No web portal.

That's 8–10 weeks of focused Cursor work. Totally doable by Fall 2025.

Add messaging in November once the core loop is proven. Add Communities in Spring. Build the web portal over winter break.

the real risk

It's not the code. It's that you'll spend 3 months building something beautiful that clubs won't use because you haven't been talking to leaders while building.

The most important thing you can do in parallel with building is running the Sykes trip manually — one more time, with paper and GroupMe — while quietly showing leaders what kindred will look like. Get their buy-in before the app is done. By the time it ships, they should already be waiting for it.

the honest summary

Path	Timeline	Risk
Build everything yourself	18 months	Miss Fall 2025 entirely
Cursor + cut scope	3–4 months	Doable but tight
Technical co-founder/contractor	2–3 months	Best shot at Fall 2025

My recommendation: cut scope to 5 screens, use Cursor hard, find one CS person at Cal Poly who wants to build something real. Ship the core loop by September. Everything else follows.

wwell I have summer - I can work 8 hours a day for 1 month

May 30

Okay that changes things. 8 hours a day for a month is 240 hours. That's a real engineering sprint.

Let me be precise about what's actually possible.

the honest math

240 hours sounds like a lot. But here's where it actually goes:

- ~40 hours — environment setup, Supabase schema, auth, roles, RLS rules. This is unsexy but if you rush it you rebuild everything twice.
- ~60 hours — Home feed + Trip Detail + Commit flow. The core three screens done properly.
- ~40 hours — Trip Packet + Personal tab (Current only).
- ~50 hours — Messaging. This alone will eat more time than you expect. Real-time anything is hard.

- ~30 hours — Communities + Create tab (basic).
- ~20 hours — Bug fixing, TestFlight, getting it on a real phone without crashing.

That's 240 hours. Perfectly mapped. Zero slack for the days Cursor fights you, Supabase RLS breaks in a way you don't understand, or React Native navigation does something inexplicable at 11pm.

reality check on messaging

Messaging is the wildcard. Real-time messaging with Supabase's `subscription` API, push notifications, channel auto-creation, photo upload, reactions — that's a 4-6 week project for an experienced developer alone.

You have two options:

Option A — build messaging properly and cut something else Drop Communities and Create tab entirely. Launch with Home, Trip Detail, Commit, Trip Packet, Personal, Messaging. Clubs get the two things they actually need — trip discovery and trip coordination.

Option B — fake messaging for V1 Use a third party. Stream Chat or Sendbird have React Native SDKs that you drop in and configure. You're not building messaging — you're connecting an API. Takes 1 week instead of 5. Costs ~\$100-300/month at your scale. Completely worth it to ship on time.

I'd do Option B without hesitation. You're a solo founder in month one. Don't build infrastructure. Buy it.

what one month actually gets you — with Option B

Week	Focus	Output
Week 1	Supabase schema + auth + roles + RLS	Database works, users can sign up with .edu email, roles assigned
Week 2	Home feed + Trip Detail	Evan can browse trips and see the Sykes page
Week 3	Commit flow + Trip Packet	Evan can commit, carpool question works, packet unlocks

Week 4 Messaging (Stream Chat) +
 Personal tab + TestFlight

Evan can message his trip crew, see his
committed trips, app on his phone

End of month: a real working app on TestFlight that you can hand to 10 people and run the Sykes trip on.

Not perfect. Not beautiful. But real.

the week 1 trap

The biggest risk in month one is spending all of week 1 making the schema perfect and beautiful and never getting to screens. Set a hard rule: schema is done by end of day 5, no matter what. You will change it later. That's fine. Supabase migrations exist. Ship the schema, move to screens.

tools to use this summer

- Cursor — your primary IDE, use it for everything
- Stream Chat — buy messaging, don't build it
- Expo — don't eject from Expo yet, it'll slow you down
- Supabase — backend, auth, storage, real-time
- Figma — spend 3 days on this before writing a line of code. Design the 5 core screens. Your north star.
- TestFlight — get the app on your phone by end of week 2, even if it's broken

the one rule for the summer

Every Friday, the app has to do one more real thing than it did Monday.

Not cleaner. Not more beautiful. One more real thing. Commit flow works. Trip Packet loads.

Messaging sends a message. That's how you know you're building and not just tinkering.

bottom line

One month, 8 hours a day, with Stream Chat for messaging and Cursor for everything else — you can ship a TestFlight-ready MVP by end of summer. Not polished. Not feature-complete. But real enough to run the Sykes trip on and pitch to club presidents in September.

That's the goal. Everything else is noise.

When do you start?

ok how can I divvy up the work?

May 30

Best question you've asked. You shouldn't be doing all 240 hours alone. Let's figure out who you actually have access to.

Q: Do you have access to any CS or software engineering students at Cal Poly right now?

A: Yes — I know CS students at Cal Poly who could help

Q: If you brought someone in — how would you compensate them?

A: Portfolio — they want the experience and something to show

May 30

Perfect. Cal Poly CS students are some of the best in the country and portfolio motivation is real — they need projects that aren't just class assignments.

Q: How many people are you thinking of bringing in?

A: however many I can - I have 2 thats pretty locked and

Q: How do you want to divide the work?

A: im front end speicifc - others can be idk. I just want it working!

May 30

Perfect. You're the product person who owns the frontend and the vision. Your two CS people own making it actually work under the hood. Clean split.

One more thing to figure out before I give you the full breakdown:

Q: What's the experience level of your two CS people?

A: Medium — they know the concepts but haven't shipped anything

Q: How do you want to work together over the summer?

A: Weekly check-ins — we meet once a week

May 30

Perfect. Here's the full summer breakdown.

the team

You — Product + Frontend You own what kindred looks and feels like. Every screen, every interaction, every pixel. You're also the domain expert — you know the clubs, the trips, the Mayas and Evans. Nobody else on the team has that.

Person 1 — Supabase + Backend Owns the database, auth, RLS rules, storage buckets, and API logic. The data layer that everything else sits on top of.

Person 2 — Integration + Features Owns Stream Chat integration, carpool logic, trip channel auto-creation, push notifications, and whatever gets built after the core loop works.

week by week

Week 1 — Foundation

Everyone together. Most important week of the summer.

- You: set up Expo project, React Native navigation skeleton, all 5 tabs rendering (empty screens), design system tokens in code (colors, fonts, spacing), kindred wordmark in the header
- Person 1: Supabase project setup, full schema (all tables), auth with .edu gate, RLS rules, seed database with fake trips and users
- Person 2: Stream Chat account setup, React Native SDK installed and running, fake channel rendering in Messaging tab

End of week 1 checkpoint: app opens on a real iPhone, 5 tabs navigate, fake data shows up, a test user can sign up with a .edu email

Week 2 — Core screens

The most visible progress week.

- You: Home feed fully built — club switcher, event type chips, trip cards rendering real Supabase data, Instagram-style layout
- Person 1: trips table fully wired to frontend, real-time spots_left counter, club_members RLS working so Evan only sees his clubs' trips
- Person 2: Trip Detail page — hero image, all pre-commit fields rendering, leader card, attendee list pulling from trip_rsups

End of week 2 checkpoint: Evan can open the app, see the Sykes trip in the feed, and tap into the full trip detail page with real data

Week 3 — The commit loop

The most important functional week.

- You: Commit flow bottom sheet — drive question, seat selector, confirmation screen, "You're in" state, button state changes throughout
- Person 1: trip_rsups table logic — insert on commit, auto-confirm, carpool data stored, spots_left decrements in real time, leader sees organized carpool list
- Person 2: Trip Packet page — all section links rendering, sub-pages for itinerary/packing/food/cost, Q&A section with real send/receive

End of week 3 checkpoint: Evan can commit to Sykes, answer the carpool question, see his Trip Packet, and ask the trip lead a question

Week 4 — Messaging + Polish

The finishing sprint.

- You: Messaging tab UI — club switcher, channel list, trip channel section, DM inbox via Stream Chat SDK skinned to kindred design, Personal tab all three sub-tabs
- Person 1: channel auto-creation trigger when leader publishes trip, committed members auto-added, 30-day archive logic, push notification setup
- Person 2: Communities tab — club directory, Club Detail page, Create tab both tabs, web nudge banner, Inspiration grid

End of week 4 checkpoint: full app on TestFlight, invite 10 real people, run a fake Sykes trip end to end

your weekly rhythm

Sunday night: each person posts a 3-bullet update in Discord — what I finished, what I'm starting, what's blocking me

Monday morning (weekly check-in): 45 minutes. First 15 — everyone demos what they built.

Last 30 — unblock anything, assign the week's tasks, kill anything that's taking too long

Friday rule: app does one more real thing than it did Monday. No exceptions.

the split in plain language

Who	Owns
You	Every screen, every component, design system, navigation, UX decisions, club relationships
Person 1	Supabase schema, auth, RLS, all database logic, API connections
Person 2	Stream Chat, push notifications, carpool logic, trip channel automation, Create + Communities

the one risk with medium-experience developers

They will get stuck and not tell you until Wednesday. Build this into your culture from day one — stuck for more than 2 hours means you post in Discord immediately. No heroics. The worst thing that happens in a month-long sprint is someone loses 3 days on a problem they could have solved in 30 minutes with a second pair of eyes.

Use Cursor together. Screen share when stuck. Nobody is expected to figure everything out alone.

what you're walking into September with

A real working app on TestFlight. The Sykes trip fully runnable on kindred. A carpool list that organizes itself. A Trip Packet that unlocks on commit. Messaging that works. Something you can hand to a club president and say — run your next trip on this.

That's enough to get five clubs to say yes.

Claude is AI and can make mistakes. Please double-check responses.

Tab 5

Think about it like levels —

Level 1 — Email gate. .edu email. You're a real student. Free. This is just baseline.

Level 2 — Attendance verification. Leader marks you attended. You showed up. Still free. But now you're in the trust graph. This is where the 3+ trips filter starts meaning something.

Level 3 — Verified organizer. You want to post beyond your immediate circles — to people you don't already know — you pay a small fee. Maybe \$5 a month. Maybe \$20 a semester. Not to use kindred. To *reach* kindred's verified network.

Tab 6

The Problem

Why the US needs Kindred.

- 1) Humans crave authentic experience. (AI burnout)
- 2)
- 3) AI increases freetime, humans should spend that freetime on human connection - made through experiences together in the outdoors.
 - a) The structural argument is strong: AI is compressing white-collar work time → current default is screens → screens are producing measurable loneliness and mental health decline → outdoor recreation + real human challenge fills the gap that screens cannot → and hard/exploratory adventures are specifically the *mechanism* by which close friendships form, not just a pleasant backdrop.
 - b) The 1950s parallel holds: when machines freed physical time, people went bowling, golfing, and fishing — and those activities built community. ([check out their hobbies](#)) The question now is whether the "AI leisure time" generation gets captured by the attention economy, or redirects toward something that actually builds the social capital they're demonstrably starved for. Are current hobbies are very individual

I. AI Is Displacing White-Collar Work (Just Like Machines Displaced Physical Labor)

The parallel to the 1950s is real and well-supported. MIT economist **Daron Acemoglu's 2024 paper "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI"** ([NBER Working Paper #32487](#)) uses a task-based model showing AI specifically displaces cognitive, knowledge-worker tasks — not manual ones — because AI has comparative advantage in information processing. The **IMF (2024)** estimated 40% of global jobs are exposed to AI, with higher-income professional roles most affected. Studies by Eloundou et al. (2024) and Kinder et al. (2024) independently confirm that occupations requiring postsecondary education — finance, law, software, professional services — show the highest exposure.

The labor market data is already showing it: In January 2025, the U.S. BLS reported the lowest job openings in professional services since 2013, a 20% year-over-year drop. The American Staffing Association found ~40% of white-collar job seekers in 2024 failed to land a single interview.

The 1950s parallel is tight: labor-saving devices (washing machines, lawn mowers) freed physical time. AI is the cognitive equivalent. The question of *where that time goes* is exactly right.

II. Where the Time Goes: Screens Are Capturing It

The 1950s answer was hobbies, books, bowling leagues, golf, fishing. Today's answer, so far, is mostly screens.

GWI's 2024 survey data on Gen Z shows the average 18-24 year old spends 6 hours 27 minutes per day on their phone alone — 9 hours across all devices — 35% higher than the global average for other generations. The average 18-24 year old logs up to 186 minutes per day on social and video platforms specifically.

Jonathan Haidt's 2024 book *The Anxious Generation* ([NYT #1 Nonfiction bestseller, 52 consecutive weeks](#)) synthesizes research showing the smartphone rewiring of childhood caused a sharp mental health decline beginning in the early 2010s — anxiety, depression, self-harm, and suicide rates more than doubled on some measures. His core finding: 1-2 hours/day of social media doesn't measurably harm mental health, but 3-4 hours/day does. Gen Z is at 3+ hours daily.

III. People Are Getting Tired of It — The Evidence for Digital Fatigue

GWI's research (2024) found 80% of Gen Z reported feeling lonely in the past 12 months — compared to just 45% of Baby Boomers. 30% of Gen Z workers feel isolated vs. 22% of other age groups. A paradox identified by researchers: up to 80% of teenagers say social media makes them lonelier, yet more than half spend more time interacting online than in person. Researchers are calling this "digital loneliness" — heavy connectivity that *intensifies* isolation rather than relieving it.

In 2023, **U.S. Surgeon General Vivek Murthy issued a formal advisory** ("Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation," [HHS.gov](https://www.hhs.gov)) declaring loneliness a public health crisis. Key statistic: in-person time with friends dropped from 60 minutes/day in 2003 to just 20 minutes/day now. The health risk of chronic loneliness is equivalent to smoking 15 cigarettes per day — greater than obesity.

Robert Putnam's *Bowling Alone* (2000) ([Journal of Democracy](#)) documented the structural decline of social capital across 500,000 interviews — fewer organizations, less home entertaining, less civic participation. The trajectory has only steepened since.

The **Survey Center on American Life's 2021 "Friendship Recession" report** (americansurveycenter.org) found men with 6+ close friends dropped from 55% → 27% since 1990. Men with zero close friends jumped from 3% → 15% — a fivefold increase.

IV. The Case That Outdoor Recreation Is Needed More Than Ever

The demand signal is already there. **The Outdoor Industry Association's 2024 Participation Trends Report** ([OIA](#)) found a record **175.8 million Americans** participated in outdoor recreation in 2023 — 57.3% of all Americans 6+, growing 4.1% year-over-year. New participants (7.7 million first-timers in 2023 alone) are driving growth across demographics.

The research on *why* is strong. A **2021 systematic review and meta-analysis in PMC** ([Nature-based outdoor activities for mental and physical health](#)) found outdoor/nature activities consistently reduced anxiety, improved mood, and enhanced emotional stability. Mechanisms are dual: (1) calming physiological effects of natural settings, (2) endorphin release from physical activity.

Dacher Keltner's (UC Berkeley) awe research ([Piff et al., Journal of Personality & Social Psychology, 2015](#); [Monroy & Keltner, 2023](#)) goes further: nature induces awe, and awe produces measurable "small self" effects — reduced ego preoccupation, increased generosity, prosocial behavior, and a sense of meaning. In one study, charitable donations after a nature hike were mediated by self-transcendence ratings. This is the direct antidote to the hyper-self-focused, metrics-driven world of social media.

V. Close Friendships Form Through Hard, Exploratory Experiences

This is the best-supported claim of all.

Arthur Aron's foundational 1997 study (*Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*) showed interpersonal closeness can be rapidly accelerated — but crucially, he noted that physiological arousal from shared challenging experiences (his famous "scary bridge" example) produces similar bonding effects to deep mutual disclosure. The arousal + vulnerability combination is the mechanism.

University of Kansas professor Jeffrey Hall's research quantified it: moving from acquaintance to close friend requires ~50 hours of shared time; becoming *best* friends takes ~200 hours. Critically, those hours accumulate fastest in shared, goal-oriented activities — not passive co-presence.

Harvey Whitehouse's Oxford research on extreme rituals ([Aeon](#); [Oxford Anthropology](#)) found the more painful and physically demanding a shared ritual, the stronger the social bonds formed. This holds across military units, firefighting crews, tribal initiations, and extreme sports groups. The mechanism is "identity fusion" — participants' sense of personal identity merges with the group.

A **2018 PMC study** ([Synchrony and Physiological Arousal](#)) found synchronous movement *combined with* physiological arousal — exactly what a hard hike, climbing route, or river

crossing produces — led to larger group clustering, tighter cohesion, and more cooperative behavior than either factor alone.

The Synthesis

The structural argument is strong: AI is compressing white-collar work time → current default is screens → screens are producing measurable loneliness and mental health decline → outdoor recreation + real human challenge fills the gap that screens cannot → and hard/exploratory adventures are specifically the *mechanism* by which close friendships form, not just a pleasant backdrop.

The 1950s parallel holds: when machines freed physical time, people went bowling, golfing, and fishing — and those activities built community. The question now is whether the "AI leisure time" generation gets captured by the attention economy, or redirects toward something that actually builds the social capital they're demonstrably starved for.

Sources:

- [Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI" \(NBER, 2024\)](#)
- [Brookings: Measuring US workers' capacity to adapt to AI-driven displacement](#)
- [GWI: Understanding Gen Z's loneliness epidemic](#)
- [McKinsey: Gen Z mental health, tech, and social media](#)
- [Haidt, "The Anxious Generation" – NYU coverage](#)
- [U.S. Surgeon General Advisory: Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation \(HHS, 2023\)](#)
- [Survey Center on American Life: The State of American Friendship](#)
- [Survey Center: America's Friendship Recession](#)
- [Putnam, "Bowling Alone" – Journal of Democracy](#)
- [OIA 2025 Outdoor Participation Trends Report](#)
- [Nature-based outdoor activities for mental and physical health – PMC meta-analysis](#)
- [Piff et al., "Awe, the Small Self, and Prosocial Behavior" \(APA, 2015\)](#)
- [Monroy & Keltner, "Awe as a Pathway to Mental and Physical Health" \(2023\)](#)
- [Whitehouse: Extreme Rituals and Social Bonding – Oxford Anthropology](#)
- [Synchrony and Physiological Arousal Increase Cohesion – PMC](#)
- [Aron, "36 Questions for Increasing Closeness" – Berkeley Greater Good](#)

The "small self" effect is a psychological phenomenon where experiencing awe—such as gazing at the night sky, walking through a redwood forest, or viewing monumental art—diminishes your sense of ego and self-importance.

Researchers at institutions like UC Berkeley's Greater Good Science Center and the American Psychological Association have linked this sudden loss of ego to profound physical and mental health benefits:

- Enhanced Prosocial Behavior: People experiencing the small self tend to act with greater kindness, empathy, and generosity.
- Reduced Stress: It lowers markers of chronic inflammation and decreases cortisol by alleviating day-to-day rumination.
- Improved Connection: Awe boosts feelings of belonging and oneness with the world, shifting the focus from "I" to "we".
- Enhanced Humility: It allows individuals to acknowledge their strengths and weaknesses in a balanced way and recognize how outside forces contribute to their successes.

Essay - Why we need kindred

Why the U.S. Needs Kindred

Abstract

I. AI Is Displacing White-Collar Work (Just Like Machines Displaced Physical Labor)

The parallel to the 1950s is real and well-supported. MIT economist **Daron Acemoglu's 2024 paper "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI"** ([NBER Working Paper #32487](#)) uses a task-based model showing AI specifically displaces cognitive, knowledge-worker tasks — not manual ones — because AI has comparative advantage in information processing. The **IMF (2024)** estimated 40% of global jobs are exposed to AI, with higher-income professional roles most affected. Studies by Eloundou et al. (2024) and Kinder et al. (2024) independently confirm that occupations requiring postsecondary education — finance, law, software, professional services — show the highest exposure.

The labor market data is already showing it: In January 2025, the U.S. BLS reported the lowest job openings in professional services since 2013, a 20% year-over-year drop. The American Staffing Association found ~40% of white-collar job seekers in 2024 failed to land a single interview.

The 1950s parallel is tight: labor-saving devices (washing machines, lawn mowers) freed physical time. AI is the cognitive equivalent. The question of *where that time goes* is exactly right.

II. Where the Time Goes: Screens Are Capturing It

The 1950s answer was hobbies, books, bowling leagues, golf, fishing. Today's answer, so far, is mostly screens.

GWI's 2024 survey data on Gen Z shows the average 18-24 year old spends 6 hours 27 minutes per day on their phone alone — 9 hours across all devices — 35% higher than the global average for other generations. The average 18-24 year old logs up to 186 minutes per day on social and video platforms specifically.

Jonathan Haidt's 2024 book *The Anxious Generation* ([NYT #1 Nonfiction bestseller, 52 consecutive weeks](#)) synthesizes research showing the smartphone rewiring of childhood caused a sharp mental health decline beginning in the early 2010s — anxiety, depression, self-harm, and suicide rates more than doubled on some measures. His core finding: 1-2 hours/day of

social media doesn't measurably harm mental health, but 3-4 hours/day does. Gen Z is at 3+ hours daily.

III. People Are Getting Tired of It — The Evidence for Digital Fatigue

GWI's research (2024) found 80% of Gen Z reported feeling lonely in the past 12 months — compared to just 45% of Baby Boomers. 30% of Gen Z workers feel isolated vs. 22% of other age groups. A paradox identified by researchers: up to 80% of teenagers say social media makes them lonelier, yet more than half spend more time interacting online than in person. Researchers are calling this "digital loneliness" — heavy connectivity that *intensifies* isolation rather than relieving it.

In 2023, **U.S. Surgeon General Vivek Murthy issued a formal advisory** ("Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation," [HHS.gov](https://www.hhs.gov)) declaring loneliness a public health crisis. Key statistic: in-person time with friends dropped from 60 minutes/day in 2003 to just 20 minutes/day now. The health risk of chronic loneliness is equivalent to smoking 15 cigarettes per day — greater than obesity.

Robert Putnam's *Bowling Alone* (2000) ([Journal of Democracy](#)) documented the structural decline of social capital across 500,000 interviews — fewer organizations, less home entertaining, less civic participation. The trajectory has only steepened since.

The **Survey Center on American Life's 2021 "Friendship Recession" report** (americansurveycenter.org) found men with 6+ close friends dropped from 55% → 27% since 1990. Men with zero close friends jumped from 3% → 15% — a fivefold increase.

IV. The Case That Outdoor Recreation Is Needed More Than Ever

The demand signal is already there. **The Outdoor Industry Association's 2024 Participation Trends Report** ([OIA](#)) found a record **175.8 million Americans** participated in outdoor recreation in 2023 — 57.3% of all Americans 6+, growing 4.1% year-over-year. New participants (7.7 million first-timers in 2023 alone) are driving growth across demographics.

The research on *why* is strong. A **2021 systematic review and meta-analysis in PMC** ([Nature-based outdoor activities for mental and physical health](#)) found outdoor/nature activities consistently reduced anxiety, improved mood, and enhanced emotional stability. Mechanisms are dual: (1) calming physiological effects of natural settings, (2) endorphin release from physical activity.

Dacher Keltner's (UC Berkeley) awe research ([Piff et al., Journal of Personality & Social Psychology, 2015](#); [Monroy & Keltner, 2023](#)) goes further: nature induces awe, and awe

produces measurable "small self" effects — reduced ego preoccupation, increased generosity, prosocial behavior, and a sense of meaning. In one study, charitable donations after a nature hike were mediated by self-transcendence ratings. This is the direct antidote to the hyper-self-focused, metrics-driven world of social media.

V. Close Friendships Form Through Hard, Exploratory Experiences

This is the best-supported claim of all.

Arthur Aron's foundational 1997 study (*Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*) showed interpersonal closeness can be rapidly accelerated — but crucially, he noted that physiological arousal from shared challenging experiences (his famous "scary bridge" example) produces similar bonding effects to deep mutual disclosure. The arousal + vulnerability combination is the mechanism.

University of Kansas professor Jeffrey Hall's research quantified it: moving from acquaintance to close friend requires ~50 hours of shared time; becoming *best* friends takes ~200 hours. Critically, those hours accumulate fastest in shared, goal-oriented activities — not passive co-presence.

Harvey Whitehouse's Oxford research on extreme rituals ([Aeon](#); [Oxford Anthropology](#)) found the more painful and physically demanding a shared ritual, the stronger the social bonds formed. This holds across military units, firefighting crews, tribal initiations, and extreme sports groups. The mechanism is "identity fusion" — participants' sense of personal identity merges with the group.

A **2018 PMC study** ([Synchrony and Physiological Arousal](#)) found synchronous movement *combined with* physiological arousal — exactly what a hard hike, climbing route, or river crossing produces — led to larger group clustering, tighter cohesion, and more cooperative behavior than either factor alone.

The Synthesis

The structural argument is strong: AI is compressing white-collar work time → current default is screens → screens are producing measurable loneliness and mental health decline → outdoor recreation + real human challenge fills the gap that screens cannot → and hard/exploratory adventures are specifically the *mechanism* by which close friendships form, not just a pleasant backdrop.

The 1950s parallel holds: when machines freed physical time, people went bowling, golfing, and fishing — and those activities built community. The question now is whether the "AI leisure time"

generation gets captured by the attention economy, or redirects toward something that actually builds the social capital they're demonstrably starved for.

Sources:

- [Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI" \(NBER, 2024\)](#)
- [Brookings: Measuring US workers' capacity to adapt to AI-driven displacement](#)
- [GWI: Understanding Gen Z's loneliness epidemic](#)
- [McKinsey: Gen Z mental health, tech, and social media](#)
- [Haidt, "The Anxious Generation" – NYU coverage](#)
- [U.S. Surgeon General Advisory: Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation \(HHS, 2023\)](#)
- [Survey Center on American Life: The State of American Friendship](#)
- [Survey Center: America's Friendship Recession](#)
- [Putnam, "Bowling Alone" – Journal of Democracy](#)
- [OIA 2025 Outdoor Participation Trends Report](#)
- [Nature-based outdoor activities for mental and physical health – PMC meta-analysis](#)
- [Piff et al., "Awe, the Small Self, and Prosocial Behavior" \(APA, 2015\)](#)
- [Monroy & Keltner, "Awe as a Pathway to Mental and Physical Health" \(2023\)](#)
- [Whitehouse: Extreme Rituals and Social Bonding – Oxford Anthropology](#)
- [Synchrony and Physiological Arousal Increase Cohesion – PMC](#)
- [Aron, "36 Questions for Increasing Closeness" – Berkeley Greater Good](#)

America is facing a crisis of connection. Over the past two decades, social media, smartphones, remote work, algorithmic entertainment, and declining participation in community institutions have reshaped how people spend time and form relationships. Although Americans are more digitally connected than ever, many are also lonelier, more anxious, and more socially fragmented. Depression and anxiety have risen sharply among young people, while in-person time with friends has declined dramatically [5](#) [6](#). This reveals a deeper problem: modern life gives people constant stimulation, but fewer embodied experiences that create real belonging.

Human beings are not built to live through screens alone. People need movement, challenge, nature, conversation, cooperation, and repeated time with others. Yet much of modern leisure is passive, private, and screen-mediated. Social media can simulate connection while weakening real friendship, and streaming or gaming can fill free time without creating community. As AI and remote work continue to change how people work and spend time, the risk is that even more of American life becomes isolated and digital.

Argument 1: AI Is Compressing White-Collar Work

The first reason the U.S. needs Kindred is that AI is beginning to compress white-collar work in the same way earlier machines compressed physical labor. Daron Acemoglu's 2024 paper, *The Simple Macroeconomics of AI*, argues that AI's economic effects operate through tasks: AI automates or complements specific forms of work, especially information-processing tasks [1](#). Similarly, the International Monetary Fund estimates that nearly 40 percent of global employment is exposed to AI, with advanced economies and high-skilled jobs especially affected [2](#). Research by Eloundou, Manning, Mishkin, and Rock also finds that large language models could affect a significant share of U.S. work tasks, with higher-income jobs facing notable exposure [3](#).

This matters because AI's impact is not only economic. It is social. If AI allows people to complete work faster, the central question becomes: what happens to the time it gives back?

Argument 2: The 1950s Show That Freed Time Can Build Community

The United States has already lived through a version of this transition. In the mid-twentieth century, labor-saving machines reduced the amount of time Americans spent on physical household work. Washing machines, lawn mowers, cars, and other technologies freed time that many people filled with social hobbies: bowling leagues, fishing trips, golf, church groups, clubs, and neighborhood recreation.

These activities were not merely entertainment. They created social capital. They gave people repeated, low-pressure ways to see each other, cooperate, compete, and build community. Robert Putnam's *Bowling Alone* famously documents the decline of these kinds of civic and social institutions, showing how weakening participation in clubs, associations, and informal social life damaged American social capital [4](#).

AI is creating a similar transition, but for cognitive labor. The question is whether the next generation of leisure time will be used to rebuild community or whether it will be absorbed by screens.

Argument 3: Screens Are Capturing Modern Free Time

The danger is that modern leisure is increasingly screen-based, individualized, and passive. Instead of joining clubs or regularly gathering in physical spaces, many

Americans now spend their free time scrolling, streaming, gaming, and consuming algorithmic content. Jonathan Haidt's work on youth mental health argues that the rise of smartphones and social media helped create a "phone-based" childhood, contributing to rising anxiety, depression, and social isolation among young people [5](#).

Digital platforms can simulate connection while weakening the conditions that make real friendship possible. A person can message dozens of people, watch hundreds of videos, and still spend almost no time physically present with friends. The result is connected isolation: constant contact without deep belonging.

If AI-generated free time simply becomes more screen time, then AI will not produce a richer society. It will produce a lonelier one.

Argument 4: Loneliness Is Now a Public Health Crisis

The need for real-world connection is urgent because loneliness is no longer just a private emotional problem. It is a public health issue. In 2023, the U.S. Surgeon General released an advisory declaring loneliness and social isolation a serious national problem, linking weak social connection to major health risks and calling for stronger community infrastructure [6](#).

The decline of friendship is especially visible among young adults and men. The Survey Center on American Life found that American men have experienced a major "friendship recession": the share of men reporting at least six close friends fell from 55 percent in 1990 to 27 percent in 2021 [7](#). This trend shows that Americans do not simply need more entertainment. They need better systems for forming and maintaining close relationships.

Kindred addresses this problem directly by creating a structure for people to meet, spend time together, and build friendships through shared experience.

Argument 5: Outdoor Recreation Is a Better Use of AI-Era Free Time

Kindred's answer to the leisure problem is not abstract. It is grounded in outdoor recreation, which is already growing in popularity. The Outdoor Industry Association reported that outdoor participation reached a record 175.8 million Americans in 2023, representing 57.3 percent of Americans age six and older [8](#). This suggests that the demand for outdoor experience already exists.

The benefits are also supported by research. A 2021 systematic review and meta-analysis found that nature-based outdoor activities can improve mental health outcomes, including mood and anxiety-related measures [9](#). Outdoor recreation combines several things that screen-based leisure lacks: physical movement, attention, novelty, shared challenge, and direct contact with the natural world.

This makes outdoor experience a powerful antidote to the passive, isolated nature of digital life. Kindred does not merely offer activities. It offers a better default for how people can spend the time AI gives back.

Argument 6: Nature Creates Awe, Humility, and Prosocial Behavior

Outdoor experience is valuable not only because it gets people away from screens, but because nature changes how people relate to themselves and others. Research on awe by Paul Piff, Dacher Keltner, and others finds that awe can produce a “small self” effect, reducing ego-centered thinking and increasing generosity, humility, and prosocial behavior [10](#).

This matters in a culture shaped by social media, where people are constantly encouraged to compare, perform, and measure themselves. Nature interrupts that pattern. A mountain, forest, ocean, desert, or night sky can make the individual self feel smaller and the social world feel larger. That shift is exactly what an isolated, hyper-individualized society needs.

Kindred’s outdoor focus therefore has a psychological purpose. It moves people into environments that naturally support humility, presence, and connection.

Argument 7: Close Friendships Form Through Shared Challenge

The strongest argument for Kindred is that friendship does not form through passive co-presence alone. It forms through repeated time, mutual vulnerability, and shared challenge. University of Kansas researcher Jeffrey Hall found that it takes roughly 50 hours to move from acquaintance to casual friend, about 90 hours to become friends, and more than 200 hours to become close friends [11](#).

Outdoor adventures accelerate this process because they create concentrated, memorable time together. A difficult hike, a cold morning, a wrong turn, a climb, a river

crossing, or a long trail gives people a shared objective. Participants are not merely talking; they are cooperating, adapting, and experiencing discomfort and achievement together.

Research on synchrony and physiological arousal also supports this mechanism. A study in *Scientific Reports* found that synchrony and arousal together can increase group cohesion and cooperation [12](#). This helps explain why hard, physical, shared experiences often create stronger bonds than ordinary hangouts. They combine movement, emotion, effort, and trust.

Kindred's value is that it turns these bonding conditions into repeatable social infrastructure.

Argument 8: Kindred Solves the Coordination Problem

Some critics might argue that people can simply organize outdoor activities on their own. Some can. But many do not. The problem is not only finding a trail or buying gear. It is finding the right people, matching experience levels, reducing social friction, building trust, and making participation feel accessible.

This is where Kindred matters. It can make meaningful outdoor experiences easier to join, repeat, and share. It can help people move from isolated individuals to durable groups. In this sense, Kindred is not just a recreation platform. It is a response to the collapse of traditional third places and the weakening of everyday community institutions.

The U.S. does not merely need more activities. It needs better mechanisms for building friendship.

Counterargument: Outdoor Recreation Is a Luxury, Not a Necessity

A critic might argue that outdoor recreation is a luxury, not a social necessity. But this objection misunderstands the scale of the problem. Loneliness, screen addiction, and social fragmentation are not minor lifestyle issues. They affect mental health, physical health, civic trust, and community resilience. When the Surgeon General treats loneliness as a public health concern, social connection becomes a serious matter of national well-being [6](#).

Outdoor recreation is not the only solution, but it is one of the most effective because it addresses several problems at once. It reduces screen time, improves mental health, creates repeated shared experiences, and gives people a concrete reason to gather in person.

Conclusion: The AI Future Needs Human Infrastructure

The future of AI should not be a society where people work less but scroll more. It should be a society where technological efficiency creates room for richer human lives. That will not happen automatically. The attention economy is already prepared to absorb every spare hour AI gives back. Platforms are optimized to capture time, not to create meaning.

Kindred offers a different answer: use that time to go outside, take on real challenges, and build real friendships. The United States needs Kindred because the next major social question is not only how AI will change work. It is how humans will stay human when work changes. If AI frees time, Americans must decide whether that time becomes passive consumption or active connection. Kindred argues for the better future: one where people use their freedom not to retreat further into screens, but to rediscover each other in the real world.

Kindred offers a response to this crisis by turning free time into shared outdoor experience. Through hiking, adventure, exploration, and group challenges, Kindred creates the conditions where friendship can form: presence, vulnerability, cooperation, and meaningful time together. In an age shaped by loneliness, depression, social media, and AI-driven changes to work, the United States needs new forms of social infrastructure that reconnect people in the real world. Kindred matters because it gives people more than convenience or entertainment; it gives them a pathway back to human connection.

Sources

[1] Daron Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI," NBER, 2024.

[2] International Monetary Fund, "AI Will Transform the Global Economy," 2024.

[3] Tyna Eloundou, Sam Manning, Pamela Mishkin, and Daniel Rock, "GPTs are GPTs,"

2023.

[4] Robert Putnam, "Bowling Alone," *Journal of Democracy*, 1995.

[5] Jonathan Haidt, *The Anxious Generation* research summary.

[6] U.S. Surgeon General, "Our Epidemic of Loneliness and Isolation," 2023.

[7] Survey Center on American Life, "American Men Suffer a Friendship Recession," 2021.

[8] Outdoor Industry Association, "2024 Outdoor Participation Trends Report."

[9] Coventry et al., "Nature-based outdoor activities for mental and physical health," 2021.

[10] Piff et al., "Awe, the Small Self, and Prosocial Behavior," 2015.

[11] Jeffrey Hall, "How many hours does it take to make a friend?" University of Kansas, 2018.

[12] Jackson et al., "Synchrony and Physiological Arousal Increase Cohesion and Cooperation," *Scientific Reports*, 2018.

Difference from allt rails

Kindred's attendance verification is fundamentally different. A leader marks you as attended. That's a human confirmation that you were physically present. That data point is what makes the trust graph real and unfakeable. AllTrails can never retrofit that onto their existing product without rebuilding from scratch.

AllTrails is for everyone. 18 year olds and 65 year olds and casual walkers and elite ultramarathoners. That universality is their strength for trail discovery and their fatal weakness for community formation.

AllTrails has zero concept of organizational membership. No club roles. No trip planning for groups. No carpool coordination. No gear shed. No permit tracking. No waitlist management.